



EL NINO EFFECT

Govt. flags 111 districts as 'primary concern'

BUSINESS » PAGE 15

FANTASTIC FEAT

Ronaldo is first man to score in six World Cups

SPORT » PAGE 17





END OF RS TERM

George Kurian resigns as Union Minister

NEWS » PAGE 13

DATA POINT

Why power utilities in T.N. are in debt

Successive governments didn't hike user charges

OPINION » PAGE 11



SECOND SET

President Murmu gives away Padma awards

NEWS » PAGE 12

NEARBY



Tiruvallur ammonia gas leak toll rises to 9

CHENNAI
The death toll in the ammonia gas leak at a private seafood processing and export facility in Tiruvallur district rose to nine on Tuesday, with the death of another worker. All the victims were women workers from Odisha and Assam. The gas leak was reported on Sunday. » **PAGE 6**



Gold ring for babies born in govt. hospitals

CHENNAI
The State government has allocated ₹755.83 crore annually for implementing the *Thaaimaaman Thanga Mothira Thittam*, under which a one-gram gold ring will be given to babies born in government hospitals. » **PAGE 6**

OPPORTUNITIES PAGE 5
► Over 1500 Jobs in today's issue

Centre tightens norms for foreign contributions

Amended FCRA Rules stipulate that NGOs must stick to specified activities in their category and geographical areas; disclosure of social media accounts and other publications made mandatory

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Non-governmental organisations (NGOs) wanting to access foreign funds must now stick to a list of activities specified by the Centre, according to the latest amendment to the Rules of the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA), 2010, notified on Monday.

While NGOs seeking foreign funds are required to register under one of the five permitted categories, namely social, economic, educational, cultural, and religious, this is the first time separate activity lists have been laid out for those in each category.

NGOs must now disclose their activities, the geographical scope of their programmes, their websites, social media accounts, and publications. They must pay separate fees for each category and State or Union Territory they operate in, as opposed to the previous single fee for FCRA registrants.

Any new registration must follow the new norms and existing registrations must comply with the

Funding check

Under the fresh changes to Rules of the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act, all NGOs are required to disclose specific activities and geographical scope of their programmes to receive contributions under 5 permitted categories:



EDUCATIONAL

- Schools, colleges, and libraries
- Scholarships
- Research institutions and think tanks
- Civic-awareness and constitutional-rights programmes



ECONOMIC

- Livelihood generation
- Skill development
- Agricultural sectors
- Entrepreneurship and micro-enterprises
- Financial and digital inclusion



RELIGIOUS

- Places of worship
- Religious education
- Pilgrim services
- Meditation programmes
- Preservation of religious traditions



SOCIAL

- Public health
- Rehabilitation
- Sanitation and nutrition
- Disaster relief



CULTURAL

- Preservation of Indian arts and languages
- Museums, archives, and cultural festivals
- Heritage conservation

changes within the next year. Any violations will be penalised with a minimum fine of ₹1 lakh, according to another order from the Union Home Ministry.

The Ministry regulates all foreign donations through the FCRA. Earlier amendments of the Rules only required NGOs to give an undertaking that their acceptance of foreign funds is not likely to affect the sovereignty and integrity of India or impact friendly relations with foreign states or disrupt communal harmony.

The amended Rules also broaden the definition of an NGO's "key functionary" beyond office-bearers and directors to include trustees, partners, the *Karta* or head of a Hindu Undivided Family, governing body members, and anyone else controlling or managing the organisation. Associations having foreign nationals (other than persons of Indian origin) as key functionaries will ordinarily not be considered eligible for registration or prior permission, unless specifically permit-

ted by the Centre, according to the new Rules. NGOs must also declare whether their association or any of their key functionaries brought out any publication during the year, including books, magazines, and newspaper articles.

A senior government official said that the amendments were effected to bring uniformity in Foreign Contribution forms (F-C) and to avoid duplication.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 12**

Wang Yi calls for resuming dialogue mechanism

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING

China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi, in talks with National Security Adviser Ajit Doval in New Delhi on Monday, called for both sides "to accelerate the resumption of dialogue mechanisms and promote exchanges" in trade, finance, and other fields, the Chinese Foreign Ministry said in a statement early on Tuesday.

He also called for the two sides "to respect each other's core interests, properly handle sensitive issues, place the China-India boundary issue in its appropriate position, and prevent it from affecting the overall situation of bilateral relations".

Mr. Wang's reference to the resumption of dialogue mechanisms being "essential" follows the Chinese Ambassador to India, Xu Feihong, saying earlier this month that most of the dialogue frameworks between India and China still remained stalled.

A brief statement from New Delhi on Monday had said both sides reviewed recent developments in bilateral relations and noted progress towards gradual normalisation in relations.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 12**

IMO announces plan to evacuate vessels stuck in Persian Gulf



The plan announced by the UN body involves two routes that ships are currently using to transit the Strait of Hormuz. REUTERS

M. Kalyanaraman
CHENNAI

International Maritime Organisation (IMO) Secretary-General Arsenio Dominguez has announced a plan to evacuate all the ships – and the 11,000 seafarers on them – stranded in the Persian Gulf due to the war in West Asia.

"This large-scale operation will be carried out in close cooperation with Iran, Oman, and all other coastal States in the region, the United States, and the maritime industry," he said.

Although his statement does not explicitly refer to Iran's plan, the plan put out by the Sultanate of Oman does mention both routes – one along the Omani coast and the other along the Iranian coast – that ships are currently us-

ing to transit the Strait of Hormuz. The plan also asks vessels to contact the respective "coastal state" of their selected route to confirm transit.

Mr. Dominguez added: "We have secured the necessary safety guarantees and have thoroughly verified the conditions for safe navigation to support these operations."

The IMO, a UN agency, referred to a letter written by Oman's Ministry of Defence to Pakistan's National Hydrographic Office that gives a detailed plan for the evacuation. Pakistan, along with Qatar, has been a mediator in the negotiations between Iran and the U.S.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 12**
'MOU HELPED ENERGY FLOW'
» **PAGE 14**

'My govt. is clear on political opposition to, administrative cooperation with the Centre'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Tuesday told the Assembly that his government stands firm in its policy of cooperative federalism and State autonomy.

He also reaffirmed his party remains ideologically opposed to the ruling party at the Centre, while making it clear that it would not oppose the Centre blindly. Mr. Vijay said his government was clear about the distinction between politics and maintaining an administrative relationship with the Centre.

"There will be no compromise on the State's rights or the TVK's political principles. We remain steadfast in this position, and there will be no deviation from it. Those who attempt to divert attention will fail," he said while speaking on the Motion of Thanks to the Governor's Address. "People, particularly minorities and our alliance partners, need not have any doubts about us. We are not anyone's team. We are solely the people's team. We are a secular and social justice-oriented movement," he said.

He said there was no se-



Hitting back: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay alleged in the Assembly on Tuesday that the Opposition parties raised law and order issues not out of genuine concern but just to spread slander. ANI

cond thought in the government that law and order should be maintained and crimes against women should not be tolerated. "We are taking measures to prevent crimes against women and have launched the Singappen Special Force. Similarly, steps are being taken to curb the menace of narcotic drugs. These issues did not begin on May 10, 2026 [when he assumed office as Chief Minister]. They have existed for a long time and were neglected," he said.

He also alleged that when Opposition parties raised law and order issues in Tamil Nadu, it appeared they did so not out of genuine concern but merely

to spread slander. He questioned why there was no permanent Director-General of Police (Law and Order) for nearly 10 months during the previous government.

"The drug menace has become widespread now. It should have been curbed at the initial stage itself. Who was responsible for it? When so many questions are being raised against the government now, I would like to ask who should have taken steps to curb the drug menace then. Who was in charge of the Police Department?" he asked.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 6**

Thirupparankundram row: State challenges HC order in top court

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Tamil Nadu government headed by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has moved the Supreme Court challenging orders passed by the Madras High Court on lighting of a lamp at a stone pillar near a dargah on the Thirupparankundram hill in Madurai district.

The High Court's Division Bench had, in early January, confirmed a previous Single Judge Bench order directing the Subramaniya Swamy Temple management in Thirupparankundram to light the *Karthigai Deepam* at the *deepathoon* (stone pillar) atop the hill, besides the usual places.

The previous DMK government had been unable to convince the court that the lighting of the lamp may stir a hornets' nest and lead to public disturbances. The Single Judge had dismissed the apprehensions of the State as an "imaginary ghost". The Bench had remarked that such a turn of events would happen only with the State's blessings, and not otherwise.

"It is ridiculous and hard to believe the fear of the mighty State that by allowing representatives of

Light and law

The Madras HC had confirmed an order on the stone pillar in January 2026

■ The previous DMK govt. had been unable to convince the court that the lighting of the lamp in Thirupparankundram may lead to public disturbances

■ The court had dismissed the apprehensions as an 'imaginary ghost'



the Devasthanam [temple management] to light the lamp at the stone pillar near the top of the hill located within its territory of Devasthanam land, on a particular day in a year, will cause disturbance to public peace. Of course, it may happen only if such a disturbance is sponsored by the State itself," the High Court Single Judge Bench had observed.

The court had urged the State to not "stoop" to that level to achieve a political agenda. It had reasoned that allowing a few persons to light the lamp and permitting worship was not an unmanageable task, the High Court had noted.

The State is being represented by advocate B. Karunakaran in the Supreme Court.



The banker to every

THE VERIFIED
NUMBER
OF INDIA'S
TRUSTED
BANKER

1600-100-100

The easy way to remember SBI's unique number
– your lifeline for cyber alerts

Never share your PIN,
OTP or CVV number

Keep your
banking details safe



BE
Scam
SAFE



For details, call 1800 1234 | 2100 or visit sbi.bank.in Follow us on



Report cyber frauds on cybercrime.gov.in or
call the Cybercrime Helpline No. 1930



A CH-CHE

INBRIEF



Corpn. Commissioner inspects civic projects in Perambur

Greater Chennai Corporation Commissioner G.S. Sameeran on Tuesday inspected civic infrastructure projects in the Perambur Assembly constituency and ordered officials to expedite work in various areas. According to a press release, work on the sports complex on Sathyamurthy Main Road would be expedited. Work on the children's park on Central Avenue and the work on refurbishing the MLA Office in Perambur is expected to be completed soon. Dr. Sameeran inspected the urban primary health centre in Satyamurthy Nagar, the release added.

EB department employee arrested on graft charges

The Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption officers on Monday arrested Balaji, assistant, Disciplinary Proceedings Section, attached to the Tangedco headquarters on Anna Salai, after he was allegedly caught accepting a bribe of ₹50,000 from a suspended employee for processing his reinstatement order.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (June 24, Wednesday), the following articles are available:

- Priyank Kharge's remark on RSS invokes the question of legal personality newsth.hive/remarkonrss
- The strange link between AI hallucination and creativity newsth.hive/aihallucination

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Metro stations on Poonamallee-Vadapalani stretch set to open, but see leaks during rain

The stretch received the final approval last month. Rainwater leakage has been reported at the concourse, ticket issuing spaces, and storage rooms of stations, including Mullaithottam and Kattupakkam. CMRL officials say contractors have been informed and have started the work to plug the leaks



Long wait: The 14.6-km stretch from Poonamallee to Vadapalani via Porur has been hit by delays since February. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

The inauguration of Chennai Metro Rail's first Phase II stretch by Prime Minister Narendra Modi may happen soon, but some issues owing to construction lacunae, such as leaks during rain continue.

The 14.6-km stretch from Poonamallee to Vadapalani via Porur, which has been plagued by delays

since February, received the final approval last month, and commuters have been waiting for the launch. But these newly built stations seem to have flaws in their design and construction as instances of rainwater leaking into the building continue to be reported in some of these stations even after short, intense spells of rain.

In stations such as Mullaithottam, Karayanchavadi, Kumananchavadi, Porur Bypass, Kattupakkam, and Thelliyaragaram, leaks were reported at the con-

course, ticket issuing spaces, and equipment storage rooms, sources said.

"There was ample time from March till June to complete all the work. If they have completed, such leaks should not be occurring. Crores of rupees have been spent on the construction of these buildings. We cannot normalise such problems. If these things happen at a house, where we are going to live in, will we accept it?" a source asked.

According to Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL)

officials, they have already started the work to plug the leaks. "The contractors have already been informed, and we are identifying ways to ensure such leaks don't occur again. The work will be completed at the earliest," an official said.

This is not the first time rainwater leaks have occurred at the stations between Poonamallee and Vadapalani. In April too, heavy rainwater leakage was seen in some of the stations after which repair work was carried out.

Webinar on early detection and treatment of scoliosis on Friday

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Ahead of International Scoliosis Awareness Day (June 27), MIOT International and *The Hindu* will organise a webinar 'Understanding Scoliosis: Early Detection, Modern Treatment, and Better Outcomes', as a part of the Wellness Series, at 11 a.m. on Friday.



can affect children, adolescents, and adults.

The session will explore the early signs and symptoms of scoliosis, importance of regular screening, advances in diagnostic techniques, and the latest treatment options available for patients across different age groups and severity levels. It will also

address common misconceptions about scoliosis and provide practical insights to patients, parents, and caregivers on effective management and care.

The session will be led by Charanjit Singh Dhillon, Director, MIOT Centre for Spine Surgery, MIOT International.

Athira Elssa Johnson, Senior Reporter, *The Hindu*, will moderate the webinar. To register, visit:

<https://newsth.hive/thmiofe> or scan the QR code.



TNEA rank list to be released on July 1

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Higher Education Minister P. Viswanathan on Tuesday said the rank list for Tamil Nadu Engineering Admissions (TNEA) 2026 will be released on July 1.

In a press release, Mr. Viswanathan said as the Central Board of Secondary Education declared the re-evaluation results on June 21, the release of the TNEA 2026 rank list was postponed from June 29 to July 1.

The counselling dates for engineering admissions

The counselling dates for engineering admissions will also be announced on the same date

will also be announced on the same date.

If there are any issues in the published rank list, a grievance redressal period will be provided from July 1 to 5. During this period, students can directly approach the nearest TNEA Facilitation Centres to rectify any issues or grievances, he added.

Timings			
CHENNAI			
WEDNESDAY, JUN. 24			
RISE	05:45	SET	18:38
RISE	14:04	SET	01:13
THURSDAY, JUN. 25			
RISE	05:45	SET	18:38
RISE	14:53	SET	01:51
FRIDAY, JUN. 26			
RISE	05:46	SET	18:39
RISE	15:44	SET	02:32

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	37	26
Chennai Airport	37	28
Chennai City	35	27

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will also be very uneasy. Spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
37°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershowers. Night will also be uneasy.

© Copyright SkyNet Weather 2026
All rights reserved.

CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

The Music Academy Madras Album Release

Today: At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall, 6.00 p.m. to 7.30 p.m. - Sri Papanasam Sivan Day - Salem Dr. Gayathri Venkatesan (Vocal), Dr. M. Narmadha (Violin), S.J. Arjun Ganesh (Mridangam) - Programme under the endowment of M/s Arun Excellor Urban Infrastructure Private Limited.

Karpaga Andhadhi Music Album Release

Today at 6.00 PM at Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Chennai Music album release of Karpaga Andhadhi in praise of Arulmigu Karpaganbal, of Arulmigu Kapaleeswarar Temple, Mysore. Lyrics by Dr. Rukmini Ramani. Music Composer & Singer: Cuddalore S.J.Janani, Chief Guest: Shri K. N. Ramaswamy, Director, Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan releases album. Dr. Sudha Seshayyan, Former Vice Chancellor, Dr. MGR Medical University receives first copy. Guests of honour: Shri.Chitra Lakshmanan, Film Director & Journalist, Cleveland Shri.V.V.Sundaram, Co Founder, Cleveland Thyagaraja Aradhana Committee, Shri.Ramesh Vinayakam, Music Composer & Smt.Priya Murle, President, ABHAI. Followed by Vocal Performance of Karpaga

Andhadhi by S.J.Janani. Artists who played in the album - Vid. Iyysri Balaji - Germany, Vid. R.Athul Kumar, Vid.Charulatha Chandrasekar, Vid.B.Ganapathiraman, Vid. Dr. K.R.Sivaramakrishna, Vid. - Vengal T. Guhan, Vid.G.K.Narasimman & Sri.K.Sakthivel. Compere Smt.Anu Kannan. All are Welcome.

Naada Inbam, 24992672
Today 6.15pm 'Sounds of the seven hills' thematic concert by Aathreyee Krishnaa, Shreelakshmi Bhat, Kaushik Sridhar. Ragasudha Hall.

Pushpanjali Cultural Trust
Today 5.30 pm at R.K Swamy Hall Mylapore Noopura Naadam by Kum S MAHATHI, Kum. G. INIYAAL & Kum S.T. AISH-WARYA. Lyrics & Music Dr. P.R Venkata Subramanian Guru Smt Lakshmi Kannan 7 pm Bharatanatyam by Kum.RAMYA VISWANATHAN (Dis.of Smt Seethalakshmi Vijay)

To advertise visit
www.thehinduads.com
☎ 044-28576300
☎ Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS

E-TENDER NOTICE

Tender Notice No.: PCMM/CLW/HWH/Procurement/26/25, Dated: 19/06/2026. PCMM/CLW/HWH on behalf of the President of India invites electronic bids from established reliable manufacturer for supply of the following. The following E-Tender's is for supply of materials for manufacture of Electric Locomotive. The Prospective/ likely suppliers are requested to look up the website www.ireps.gov.in for detailed instructions. These are E-Tenders only electronic bids shall be accepted. No. Tender Nos. Description of Stores: Quantity: Bid On: Tender Cost are as follows : [086]: 14262674; Set of Blower Gasket To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0457/F (Set Detail Attached); As Per Tender/Document; 24/07/2026; ₹ 0.00. [087]: 14262608; Spring Loaded Switch -1 To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0032/H; As Per Tender/Document; 27/07/2026; ₹ 0.00. [088]: 14262610; Crew Fan To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0110/E; As Per Tender/Document; 30/07/2026; ₹ 0.00. [089]: 14262979; LED Based Flasher Light To Drg./Spec. No. (i) ELRS/ SPEC/LFL0017 (Rev.1, Sept.2004) & (ii) CLW/ES/SK-3-L-21-C; As Per Tender/Document; 03/08/2026; ₹ 0.00. [092]: 14262505; Primary Voltage Transformer To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0009/C; As Per Tender/Document; 31/07/2026; ₹ 0.00. [091]: 14262652; Set Of Non-Metallic Pipe (Smoke Detector Pipe) To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0254/E (Set Detail Attached); As Per Tender/Document; 10/08/2026; ₹ 0.00. [092]: 13126174A; Pressure Sensor Oil Circuit Transformer As Per Specification No. CLW/ES/3/0035/H; As Per Tender/Document; 20/07/2026; ₹ 0.00. PCMM/CLW/Howrah P/2/394

☎ Like us on: [facebook.com/chitrilways](https://www.facebook.com/chitrilways)

MSME TECHNOLOGY CENTRE

Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises Govt. of India

2 Days Government Certificate Course on

AI FOR BUSINESS AUTOMATION

Course Duration (ONLINE) Date: 27 & 28 June 2026

2 Days Time: 4:00 PM to 8:30 PM

Course Content: Introduction & Foundation of business automation, GenAI and office productivity - email automation, document generation and AI assistant, AI AGENTS - NO CODE for Legal, Finance, Operations department with completely free and government compliant tools, AI Governance, Ethics, and Security, Business Reporting and Dashboards, and Customer Support Process, How to Make AI Agents and Chatbots for any task..More

Fees : Rs.3,540/- (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)

Coordinator: 9818676612, 9818528498, 9868564246

Government of India certificate will be awarded

ENGINEERING WORKS

Tender Notice No. CON/2026/JUN/04; Dated: 17-06-2026. Open tender through e-tendering system is invited from experienced and reputed contractor (s)/firms for the following works. Tender No. CE-CON-DK-EPC-2026-05 Name of work: "Construction of Balance Work of Single Line BG Tunnel No. 10 Main Tunnel (Length-1924 m) and Escape Tunnel (Length-1630 m) and other ancillary Works between Ck. 60760.0 m to Ck. 66280.0 m in Pipham to Menguzuma Section in Connection with Dimapur-Kohima New BG Line Project". Approximate Value: ₹631.04, ₹2,933.16/-

- E-tender will be closed at 14:30 hrs. on 29-07-2026 and opened at 15:30 hrs. on 04-08-2026. For details of Tender please visit www.ireps.gov.in.

Chief Engineer/Con/NL Project/ Maligaon

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY (Construction Organisation)

"Serving Customers with a smile"

ANNUAL MAINTENANCE CONTRACT

E-Tender Notice No. TSK/Elect/244; dated: 19-06-2026. Works tender through E-Tendering System are invited by the undersigned for the following works: SN.1. Brief Description of Item: Annual maintenance contract of RBC-cum-EBCs of Electro waves Electronics Pvt. Ltd. make in coaches of Dibrugarh and Tinsukia coaching depots covering breakdown and preventive maintenance, repair and supply of spare parts for a period of 2 (two) years. (Tender No. LV-T-14-TSK-TLAC-27) Tender Value: ₹60,48,486.64/-; Earnest Money: ₹1,21,000/- SN.2. Brief Description of Item: Annual Maintenance Contract of RBC-cum-EBCs of Hitachi Hi-Rel Power Electronics Pvt. Ltd. make in coaches of Dibrugarh and Tinsukia coaching depots covering breakdown and preventive maintenance, repair and supply of spare parts for a period of 2 (two) years. (Tender No. LV-T-14-TSK-TLAC-28) Tender Value: ₹37,01,312.72/-; Earnest Money: ₹74,000/- SN.3. Brief Description of Item: Annual Maintenance Contract of RBC-cum-EBCs of Signotron (India) Pvt. Ltd. make in coaches of Dibrugarh and Tinsukia coaching depots covering breakdown and preventive maintenance, repair and supply of spare parts for a period of 2 (two) years. (Tender No. LV-T-14-TSK-TLAC-29) Tender Value: ₹19,86,070.24/-; Earnest Money: ₹74,000/- SN.4. Brief Description of Item: Annual Maintenance Contract of RBC-cum-EBCs of Electronic Equipment Company Pvt. Ltd. make installed in coaches of Dibrugarh and Tinsukia coaching depots covering breakdown and preventive maintenance, repair and supply of spare parts for a period of 2 (two) years. (Tender No. LV-T-14-TSK-TLAC-30) Tender Value: ₹21,66,622.08/-; Earnest Money: ₹43,300/- SN.5. Brief Description of Item: Annual Maintenance Contract of RBC-cum-EBCs of Hind Rectifiers Limited make in coaches of Dibrugarh and Tinsukia coaching depots covering breakdown and preventive maintenance, repair and supply of spare parts for a period of 2 (two) years. (Tender No. LV-T-14-TSK-TLAC-31) Tender Value: ₹19,86,070.24/-; Earnest Money: ₹39,700/- SN.6. Brief Description of Item: Annual Maintenance Contract of RBC-cum-EBCs of IC Electricals Company Limited make in coaches of Dibrugarh and Tinsukia coaching depots covering breakdown and preventive maintenance, repair and supply of spare parts for a period of 2 (two) years. (Tender No. LV-T-14-TSK-TLAC-32) Tender Value: ₹9,02,759.20/-; Earnest Money: ₹18,100/- SN.7. Brief Description of Item: Annual Maintenance Contract of RBC-cum-EBCs of Autometers Alliance Limited make in coaches of Dibrugarh and Tinsukia coaching depots covering breakdown and preventive maintenance, repair and supply of spare parts for a period of 2 (two) years. (Tender No. LV-T-14-TSK-TLAC-33) Tender Value: ₹2,70,827.76/-; Earnest Money: ₹5,400/-

- E-tenders will be closed at 13:00 hrs. on 13-07-2026 and opened at 15:00 hrs. on 13-07-2026. The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available upto 13:00 hrs on 13-07-2026 in website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

DRM (Elect.)/Tinsukia

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY

"Serving Customers with a smile"

CLASSIFIEDS MART

TO ADVERTISE VISIT

www.thehinduads.com

CALL: 044-28576300 • TOLL FREE: 1800 102 4161

or Contact your nearest Authorised space sellers

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

EDUCATIONAL

VACANCIES

I. THUSHITA, D/o. Mariaselvan A. R/o. 1E2, Jains Inseli Park, OMR, Padur, Ch- 603103, have added my surname as Mariaselvan vide Affidavit Dt: 20.06.2026 sworn before Notary K.Sivaraman, Thiruppur, Chennai. Henceforth, I shall be known as Thushita Mariaselvan for all legal purposes

I. MANJULA Xavier, daughter of Saverinathan Arakiraj, residing at 2/4, 10th Street Cross Street, Mandavelipakkam, Raja Annamalaiapuram, Chennai, Tamil Nadu - 600028, have changed my name to Margaret Manjula Xavier and will henceforth be known as Margaret Manjula Xavier for all purposes.

I. PRAVEEN SUBRAMANIAN N son of S. NATARAJAN residing at Plot No. 3, Bharathi Avenue, CHPP Nagar, Milanamali Avadi, Post Morai, Dist-Tiruvallur, Chennai-600055 have changed my name from PRAVEEN SUBRAMANIAN N to N PRAVEEN SUBRAMANIAN vide Affidavit dated 22/06/2026 at High Court Chennai

I. Kunal Chovatia Kamlesh, S/o. Kamlesh, Residing at D Block 803 KLP Abhinandan Apartment, 1 Strahans Road, Pattalam, Perambur Barracks Chennai - 600012, shall henceforth be known as Kunal Chovatia.

I. CLARANCE FATHIMA spouse of H.A. Joseph, Residing at, 26/8, Sarada Flat, Varadarajan Pet Main Road, Kodambakkam, Chennai - 600024, Have Changed my Name from CLARANCE FATHIMA to CLARA FATHIMA RANI. J vide Affidavit dated 21/06/2026 at Chennai.

I. VIDHYAA Karthik, wife of Thiru Karthik S. born on 3rd September 1988 (District of Birth: Chennai), residing at Old No. 16, New No. 15/7, 27th Street, Thillai Ganga Nagar, Nanganallur, Chennai - 600 061, shall henceforth be known as VIDHYAA MANOHARAN, Chennai, 5th June 2026. VIDHYAA KARTHIK

OLD AGE HOME

PALLIATIVE CARE at your home Trained Nurses, 24/7, Dr. Physio visits, Lab tests 1800-313-1883 tikotra.com/seniors

THANKSGIVING

THANK YOU Sacred Heart of Jesus, Mother Mary, St.Joseph, St.Antony and St.Expedite for favours received.

BUSINESS OFFERS

LOANS FOR CIBIL Defaulter/Salaried/Business/Pensioners Ctl 8148017757

INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITY Investor Required for Layout Development: 7 Acres Adjacent to Sriperumbudur New Bangalore Highway. Secured & Good ROI. Cosmic Properties 90907 55000

PEST CONTROL

NETLON SAINTGOBAIN SS Doortype SV Trading Authorised Dealer 99403886715

GENERAL

Dr. MGR INSTITUTE of Special Education and Research

ADMISSION OPEN

B. Ed., Special Education Course Comprehensive Teacher Training Program focusing on Special Students

★ 100% Placement Assured in Normal / Special Schools

★ Quality Training by Specialized Faculty

★ Teachers trained here are eligible for all schools and specially qualified for hearing impaired

★ An Exclusive Course available in Campus

ENROLL NOW

DR. MGR HOME & SCHOOL for the Speech and Hearing Impaired, Mount Poonamallee Rd, MGR Garden, Ramapuram, Chennai - 60

mgrhomeschool@gmail.com

82208 43793

91762 08626

70102 77808

SITUATION VACANT

CONSULTANTS

REQUIRED

Hydrographic/Geologist Consultant

having minimum experience of 5 years for a company in Mumbai

Mail Resume to secretary@hindoffshore.com

FINANCE

REQUIRED COMMERCE Graduates or CA Inter for Audit Firm to work as Paid Assistant, Nungambakkam, 99403 76800. Email ID : gasmdansr@gmail.com

LOOKING FOR FRESH CHARTERED ACCOUNTANT

Chennai Based Chartered Accountant office looking for Qualified Fresh Chartered Accountant willing to slog and learn with career growth. Salary based on the skill, knowledge and performance. If found suitable, long term association is also possible. If interested Email: vevasanth@gmail.com

SITUATION VACANT

FINANCE

LEADING MNC IT Company - Chennai (Ambattur) hiring for Finance Controller Exp: 15+ yrs Qual/Cert: CA/CMA/M.Com, IFRS. Call/ WhatsApp CV: +91 9500098556

GENERAL

REG MARKETERS for Real Estate @ Ambattur/Kundrathur/ Redhills 9176619522

WE ARE looking for Admin - Front desk. Freshers & Experienced candidates. Good communication skills and computer knowledge must. Send your CV : rbamineralsmetalsprvtltd@gmail.com 80560 23496

WORK FROM Home Fixed Sal Inc Pcf for VRS NRI Banker Hsewife. 9841292921

ADMIN HEAD/MENTOR Leading MNC Rtd/ NRI Fixed upto 75k+Age45+. 7200269114

WANTED: SENIOR Legal Associate- Advocates experience in Court Matters/ Litigation/ Police Station/ Revenue Department/ Registration Department Preferred. Salary: Rs.30,000 per month onwards Location: Vox Group, Mysore, Chennai Ct: 99400 99777

WANTED FEMALE Admin with Basic System Knowledge at Adyar. 9840951591

Powercare Solutions Pvt Ltd Requires

1. MEP, Structural & Civil Constructions

2. Material Handling & Construction Equipment (BDM & Sales Manager)

M/F for their Corporate Office, Min 5yrs exp. Sal: 35K to 1.5L + Inc. Contact/ Email: RR Towers 5, 5th Flr, Guindy Indl. Estate, Ch-32

**Shape the future
with confidence**

A stethoscope with a black tube and silver-colored metal parts, including the chest piece and ear tips, is coiled on a solid yellow background.



Total MBBS Selections from ALLEN South



Boys & Girls Separately

CM
VK

INBRIEF



Indian Bank distributes bags, notebooks to school students

Indian Bank, as part of its Corporate Social Responsibility initiative, distributed school bags and notebooks to 352 students of Chennai High School on Eldams Road in Teynampet. According to a press release, Mini T.M., Executive Director, Indian Bank, distributed the bags and notebooks on the occasion. Vallery Rath, CGM, and Balaji S., DGM, of the bank, along with the school's headmistress and teachers, were present.

Nominations invited for National Mahaveer Awards

The Bhagwan Mahaveer Foundation has invited nominations from Tamil Nadu for the 30th edition of the “National Mahaveer Awards 2027”. The awards recognise individuals and institutions whose work has transformed lives and communities in the fields of Non-Violence and Vegetarianism, Education, Medicine, and Community and Social Service. Nominations are open until July 31, 2026. Nomination forms can be downloaded from www.bmfawards.org. Each award carries a cash prize of ₹10 lakh, a citation and a memento. Over the past three decades, the foundation has honoured 101 individuals from 26 States and two Union Territories, with Tamil Nadu accounting for 17 awardees. According to a press release, the awardees will be selected by a jury chaired by Justice M.N. Venkatachaliah, former Chief Justice of India.

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THE PUBLISHING PVT. LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

GCC revives advertising project to boost revenue; aims to net ₹108 crore

Space for advertising is planned at bus bays, streetlight poles, and parks; there are plans to also cover community halls, playgrounds, sports facilities, and other public places under the project

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

To boost its ‘own-source’ revenue, the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has revived a citywide advertising project after six months across over 1,400 locations, expecting a total revenue of ₹108 crore.

New revenue sources
GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran, in an interview with *The Hindu*, had mentioned that the civic body, “will be concentrating on the GCC's own-source revenues and new revenue-generating mechanisms such as advertisements, and there are upcoming public-private partnership projects in the pipeline. Apart from this, outsourcing bus bays and identifying unassessed or under-assessed properties will also be pursued to sustain the local body's expenditure.”
In December 2025, the GCC floated tenders expecting a turnover of ₹75 crore via this project.
According to GCC officials, the project planned this year includes 35 bus bays with a total advertising

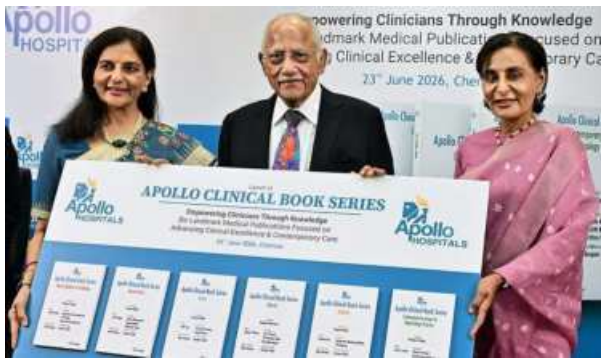


Optimal use: The concessionaire will be allowed to use up to 90% of the approved advertising area commercially, while the remaining would be reserved for the GCC's public messages. FILE PHOTO

ing area of 1,691 sq.m, 12,219 streetlight poles on bus-route roads with a combined display area of 34,267 sq.m, 1,534 parks with 52,437 sq. m of display space, and 614 other streetlight poles with an overall display size of 1,223 sq.m.
It also covers advertising rights on the Mambalam-T. Nagar skywalk and the new steel bridge in T. Nagar.
In addition, advertisements have been proposed in shopping complexes,

community halls, community centres, playgrounds, and sports facilities across the city.
Tender terms
According to officials, the concessionaire will be allowed to use up to 90% of the approved advertising area commercially, while the remaining would be reserved to display the GCC's public messages.
The permitted licensed advertisers concessionaire must design, install, oper-

ate, and maintain the advertising infrastructure at their own cost and restore the facility in good condition at the end of the concession period.
Penalties for damages - from ₹1,000 to ₹10,000 a day - could be imposed for lapses such as damaged advertising displays, electrical faults, unauthorised content, safety violations, failure to remove graffiti or debris, and non-compliance with GCC's instructions.



Prathap C. Reddy, founder & chairman, Apollo Hospitals; Preetha Reddy, vice-chairperson, Apollo Hospitals, and Suneetha Reddy, Managing Director, Apollo Hospitals, launching the books. R. RAGU

City hospital launches clinical book series to improve patient care

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Apollo Hospitals launched the Apollo Clinical Book Series, comprising six medical books aimed at equipping clinicians with the knowledge of evolving clinical practices and emerging therapies to improve patient care.
The books are on updates in cardiology, nephrology practice, breast cancer, stroke, obesity and its management, and diabetes.
The series was launched by Prathap C. Reddy, Founder and Chairman, Apollo Hospitals Group; Preetha Reddy, Vice Chairperson, Apollo Hospitals Group; and Suneeta Reddy, Managing Director, Apollo Hospitals Group.
Dr. Prathap Reddy said that while Apollo was performing advanced robotic cardiac surgeries and neuro-interventions to the

highest standards, it also remained committed to serving ordinary people.
He said medical care in India was now on a par with, and in some areas even ahead of, that in Western countries, marking a significant shift from the situation four decades ago. He added that India was poised to emerge as a global healthcare destination.
Forewords to the six books were written by senior Apollo experts, including Dr. Prathap Reddy for cardiology and nephrology, Ms. Preetha Reddy for breast cancer, Ms. Suneeta Reddy for stroke, Shobana Kamineni for obesity, and Sangita Reddy for diabetes. Anupam Sibal, Group Medical Director, Apollo Hospitals Group, and Raju Vaishya, Editor-in-Chief, Apollo Medicine, editors, and co-editors of the books were also present.

Chamber format plays to mark ‘Crazy’ Mohan’s birth anniversary

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

To mark the 75th birth anniversary of playwright ‘Crazy’ Mohan, his troupe, Crazy Creations, will stage his famous plays in a chamber format for smaller audiences, making

the performances more interactive. Called ‘Chamber of Humour’, the first such performance will be held from 5.30 p.m. onwards on June 28 at the MDND office in Mylapore. Tickets, priced at ₹500 each, will be available at the venue.

Actor Maadhu Balaji said, “We drew inspiration from chamber concerts and light music programmes held in homes. We have titled it ‘Chamber of Humour’ because it offers an hour-and-a-half of pure humour in an intimate chamber setting. Our

troupe is among the pioneers in staging plays at IT companies, apartment complexes, and even senior citizens’ homes. We are aiming to get closer to the audience. People want an opportunity to talk about the genius that ‘Crazy’ Mohan was. The performance

will be for a small audience, seated in close proximity to the artists. After the show, they will have an opportunity to interact with the actors, which may not be possible in larger halls. It will be a no-set, no-mic performance.” For details, call 98410 49386.

GREATER CHENNAI CORPORATION / MECHANICAL ENGINEERING / INSPECTION VEHICLE DEPOT
E-TENDER IS INVITED FOR THE FOLLOWING WORK BY SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (MECHANICAL)
M.E.D.I.V.D.C.No.D5/ 064 / 2026
Hiring of 14 Nos. of Private Drivers for Inspection Vehicle Depot for a Period of 365 days on Contract Basis.
Earnest Money Amount **Rs.63,000/-** as per the tender notice.
Last date and time of submission :- **20.07.2026 @ 3:00 P.M**
Tender opening Date & Time :- **21.07.2026 @ 3.30 P.M**
Tender details can be downloaded from: <http://tntenders.gov.in> (We inform you through the website)
DIPR/2123/Tender/2026 **Superintending Engineer (Mechanical)**

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

May Her Soul Rest in Peace
Funeral Services will be held at Our Lady of Angels Church – Karaikal – Puducherry
Funeral Date: 25.06.2026
Nirmala Amali Francis
03 Dec 1953 – 23 June 2026
Deeply Mourned by
Husband – Udayakumar Francis (Reid UCO Bank Officer)
Son – Leo Francis (Australia)
Son – Antony Francis (Australia)
Grand Son – Oliver Francis (Australia) and Family Members
Forever in our hearts, always in our prayers.

DEATH

IN LOVING MEMORY OF
Late Mrs. R. YASODHARA
Passed Away on 19.06.2026
The family members respectfully inform relatives, friends and well-wishers that the 7th Day Karayam & Purnima Archanam of the departed soul will be performed as per family customs @ Padi Shivan Koil, Sam on 25 June 2026
Family Members

DEATH

Mr. S. Narayanan
Passed away on 23.06.2026
Deeply mourned by Management & Employees of **Bimetal Bearings Ltd.**
Ph: 90033 74393

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

SIXTH ANNIVERSARY
U. LOGABABU (Age:83)
Retd. Sr. Supervisor (Comp. NEWS)
42 Yrs Service, THE HINDU
APPA - A beacon of wisdom, integrity and resilience. Amid profound adversity, he embraced the dual mantle of parenthood with devotion. His sacrifices, strength and values remain our enduring inspiration and inheritance.
Dr.L.Jambulingam (IIT), L.Devika, J.Prema, R.Lakshmanan Tlak Kumar Grandchildren: R.Avinash, L.Karthika, J.Nithyalakshmi, L.Balavignesh, Great Grandchild: A.Aarav Sai, Relatives and Friends

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

EIGHTH ANNIVERSARY
Mrs.KANCHAN KHUBCHANDANI
(20-12-1957 TO 24-06-2018)
Fondly Remembered by:
Husband: **Ashok Khubchandani**
Son: **Manish Khubchandani** Daughters: **Trishu (Esha) & Komal**
Daughter-in-law: **Rehmat Khubchandani**
Sons-in-Law: **Sunil Bajaj & Ajay Awtaney**
Grandchildren: **Jas Parv Navya Piya Maahir Shlok Naksh Khubchandani Bhagtani Chatlani Sufidar Family & Friends**

OBITUARY

With profound grief we inform the passing away of **Mrs. Padmaja Srinivasan**
W/o. T.S. Srinivasan
On **23.06.2026** at Chennai. She was a great musician, a devoted wife and mother and a loved Grandmother.
Deeply Mourned & Missed by Son Sridhar Srinivasan and Indira Ravindran and family members and relatives.
Sridhar +91 80562 64186

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

25th ANNIVERSARY
AL.THENAPPAN
(Real Estate Agent)
You have never gone You still live in our hearts
Nagu, Alagappan, Adaikkappan & Family members
Cell: 9840055577

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FOND REMEMBRANCE 20TH ANNIVERSARY
DoB : 27.02.1933 DoD : 24.06.2006
SMT. REVATHI RAGHAVAN
You have left us 20 Years ago but your memory is forever fresh in our hearts
Warmly remembered by J Raghavan, Jagannathan & Usha, Prema & Anand Balaji & Asha, Seshadri, Vijayasathay and Priya Grandchildren & Great Grandchildren

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

SECOND YEAR MEMORIAL ANNIVERSARY
Dr. P. KUGANANTHAM
(Former City Health Officer, Chennai Corporation, Public Health Expert)
23.07.1956 - 24.06.2024
In loving memory of our beloved Father
We are proud to be ever guided by your ethics, thoughts, philosophy - and your memory is the pillar on which we learn & draw strength from
Remembered by
Dr. Jalaja (Wife)
Daughters: Dr. Hamsadvani & Dr. Aarthi
Son-in-law: Varun Joshua,
Brothers: Krishnanandam & Thulasiraman Family, Friends & Relatives

Kattaikkuttu Sangam holds training programme

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Recognising the need for the next generation of Kattaikkuttu practitioners, the Kattaikkuttu Sangam in Kancheepuram district announced its diploma course for 2026 for aspiring artistes and students. The course will be taught by veteran artiste Perungattur P. Rajagopal and his team of teachers and musicians.

A shorter three-and-a-half-month segment, scheduled from October 1, 2026, to January 15, 2027, costs ₹35,000.

The 10-month diploma course is offered at a fee of ₹80,000 covering tuition, shared accommodation, and food. There are 15 sponsored seats (partial or in full) for persons who face financial constraints, on the condition that they commit to the full 10-months training programme and contribute to the organisation.

Registration is open at <https://www.kattaikkuttu.org/> or in person at the Sangam's office before July 31, 2026.

High Court Bench strikes down Section 34-C of Registration Act

The Act concerns documents and their registration. However, rights and liabilities of parties arising out of transaction affecting property are governed by the Transfer of Property Act, the court says

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court, on Tuesday, struck down Section 34-C of the Registration Act and held it to be *ultra vires* of the Constitution.

Hearing a batch of petitions seeking declaration that Section 34-C of the Act was manifestly arbitrary and violative of Articles 14, 21, and 300A of the Constitution, a Division Bench of Justices N. Sathish Kumar and M. Jothiraman held that by permitting the Sub-Registrar to exercise powers to ascertain whether the person executing the document possessed a title over the immovable property, the impugned provision authorised an authority exercising ministerial and administrative functions to probe questions of title which were within the exclusive province of the courts.

"The impugned provision is, on the face of it, unconstitutional and violative



The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court held Section 34-C to be *ultra vires* of the Constitution on Tuesday. FILE PHOTO

of Article 14 of the Constitution as it clearly breaches the principle of separation of powers as held by the Supreme Court," the court said.

Section 34-C of the Act commenced with a non-obstante clause. The Act was concerned primarily with documents and their registration, and not with the underlying transactions affecting property. The rights and liabilities of parties arising out of such transactions were governed by the substantive provisions of the Transfer

of Property Act, the court said.

The Registration Act merely provided the procedural framework for registration and public notice of documents, whereas the validity, effect, and legal consequences of transactions were governed by the Transfer of Property Act. Therefore, any provision in the Registration Act that sought to regulate or determine substantive rights in immovable property must be examined in the light of the scheme and provisions of the Transfer

of Property Act, the court said.

Encumbrance register

The court directed the Inspector General of Registration to prepare and publish a comprehensive list of encumbrances in Book I, indexed survey number wise and door number wise. The exercise should be undertaken forthwith in all Sub-Registrar Offices across Tamil Nadu and completed in a phased manner. The Inspector General of Registration should ensure that all transactions in respect of all the survey numbers were reflected in the encumbrance register without fail.

The court also directed the Inspector General of Registration to undertake the exercise of verifying the integrity of encumbrance entries in Book I, indexed survey number wise and door number wise, and to ensure that the same were properly reflected in the encumbrance certificates.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
Open Tender through E-Tendering
CWM/Carriage & Wagon workshop North western railway Bikaner acting for and on behalf of the president of India invites E-Tender No. 07R-MECH-BKNW-BOXNHL-26. **Name of work and its location:** Rehabilitation of BOXNHL Wagons as per scope of work at C & W Workshop, NWR, Bikaner. **Estimated Cost of work:** Rs. 3,74,61,294.00 (Inclusive of GST). **Earnest money:** Rs. 7,49,200.00. **Last Date and time for submission and opening of E-tender:** 14.07.2026 at 14:30 Hrs. E-Tender will be opened at 15:00 Hrs. on same day. **Website particular where complete details of e-tender can be seen:** www.ireps.gov.in **905-MG/26**
Follow us on: [f](#) [in](#) [tv](#) [NWR](#) [Railways](#) [NWR](#) [Railways](#)

CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-PROCUREMENT NOTICE
D.Y.C.M.M./M/PAREL, E-PROCUREMENT Notice No. - e-61/2026 Dt. 22.06.2026 **Tender No:** 48256001B **ITEM DESCRIPTION:** 1. Stripping of Switch board cabinet conforming to RDSO specification no. RDSO/PE/SPEC/ AC/0184- 2015, REV-1 or latest for 150 coaches at PR/W.S. [Inspection Agency: TPI, Stage Insp.: No, Stages : 0] **UVAM Linking:** Item :2400045, Switch Board cabinet for LHB EOG AC coaches Item Type: Goods (supply) **QTY:** 100 Nos. **2. Fitment, testing & commissioning of Switch board cabinet conforming RDSO/PE/SPEC/AC/0184-2015, REV-1 or latest for 150 coaches at PR W/S. [Inspection Agency: TPI, Stage Insp.: No, Stages : 0] UVAM Linking:** Item :2400045, Switch Board cabinet for LHB EOG AC coaches Item Type: Goods (supply) **QTY:** 100 Nos. **3. SWITCH BOARD CABINET FOR LHB EOG AC COACHES** as per Drg. No. RDSO/PE/SPEC/AC/0184- 2015 (Rev. 1) OR LATEST, Packag Instruction - P1115 VER 3.0 [Warranty period: 30 Months after the date of delivery] [Inspection Agency: TPI, Stage Insp.: No, Stages : 0] **UVAM Linking:** Item :2400045, Switch Board cabinet for LHB EOG AC coaches Item Type: Goods (supply) **QTY:** 100 Nos. **T.O.D.:** 03rd Aug-2026 **Allocation/ UWID/WO NO:** 20213604/ 01001240755040067 **Tender Value Rs.:** 52068680.00 Complete details of tenders are available at Central Railway official website www.ireps.gov.in in the complete documents can be downloaded from the website. **[288]**
Travel safely, Avoid footboard travelling

ANDHRA UNIVERSITY
DPIIT - IPR Chair
Centre for Intellectual Property Rights Visakhapatnam - 530001, India
EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION
AU IPR Advt/2026/2
Andhra University invites applications from Indian Nationals for the post of **IPR Chair Professor (01 position)** on contract basis under SPRIHA Scheme of DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce & Industry, Govt. of India. For details like eligibility criteria, mode of selection and other details please visit www.andhrauniversity.edu.in. **Last Date for receipt of Application : 10-07-2026.**
Date: 22-06-2026 **Sd/- Registrar**

CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
For & on behalf of President of India, Dy. Chief Engineer (Bridge Line) HQ at Central Railway, G. M. Building, 2nd Floor, CSMT Mumbai-400 001 invites e-bids at e-Procurement website, "[http:// www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in)" for the following work: **S N. 1 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR052026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Structural repairs and replacement of corroded/loose rivets & other steel members and painting of track girder bridges in various section (CSMT-CLA, CLA-TMBY, TNA-VSH) of Mumbai division. (09 bridges) **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 1,16,24,501.58/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 2,32,500/- **Completion period :** 09 months **S N. 2 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR072026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Improvement of structural life of bridges by replacement of corroded rivets & structural repairs of various track girder bridges in DW-BSR section over Mumbai division. (05 nos. bridges) **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 85,64,227.00/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 1,71,300/- **Completion period :** 09 months **S N. 3 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR082026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Structural repair and Replacement of perforated decking plate, corroded loose rivets of Moola bridge no 390/1 Dn Line in DD-MMR section of Pune Division. **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 1,25,48,178.45/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 2,51,000/- **Completion period :** 09 months **S N. 4 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR092026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Replacement of Bed plates and Correction of alignment, Cross level & Longitudinal levels/position and structural repair in Various bridges of DD-SUR and KVV-MRJ section of Over Solapur Division. **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 51,77,433.97/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 1,03,600/- **Completion period :** 06 months **S N. 5 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR102026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Protective Coating Metallizing & Painting, replacement of footpath, corroded/loose rivets of Steel girder bridges on BSL-KNW Section of BSL Division. **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 91,42,641.31/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 1,82,900/- **Completion period :** 09 months (excluding moonson) **S N. 6 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR112026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Protective Coating by Metallizing & Painting of various Steel Bridges on running lines of BSL-KNW & BSL-BD Section of BSL Division. **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 73,95,030.95/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 1,47,900/- **Completion period :** 06 months (excluding moonson) **S N. 7 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR122026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Protective Coating by Metallizing & Painting of various Steel track girder bridges of CSN-DHI section over BSL division. **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 1,45,49,171.33/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 2,91,000/- **Completion period :** 09 months (excluding moonson) **S N. 8 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR132026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Protective coating by painting work of TGB & ROB in BSL-IGP section over BSL division. **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 51,61,281.83/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 1,03,200/- **Completion period :** 06 months (excluding moonson) **S N. 9 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR142026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Conventional Painting for safety of bridges of TGB's & ROB's in ET-NGP, WR-BPQ & Koradi-Godhan-Kalamna Branch Line sections over NGP Division. **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 15,036.00/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 1,38,300/- **Completion period :** 06 months (excluding moonson) **S N. 10 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR152026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Conventional Painting for safety of bridges of TGB's & ROB in WUN-PMKT, MJRI-RAJUR & BD-NGP sections over NGP Division. **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 63,84,419.00/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 1,27,700/- **Completion period :** 06 months (excluding moonson) **S N. 11 Tender Notice No. & date :** CR-BR162026-27, dated 18.06.2026 **Name of work :** Structural repair and Replacement of corroded/loose rivets, Lifting of bridge providing wider and thicker bed plate and provision of jacking bracket on various track girder bridges in MRJ-KOP section of Pune Division. **Approx cost of work in Rs. :** Rs. 1,02,42,623.23/- **EMD Rs. :** Rs. 2,04,900/- **Completion period :** 06 months **Date & Time of closing: 10.07.2026 at 15.00 Hrs.** 1. Complete information of above e-tender notice is available on website "<http://www.ireps.gov.in>". 2. Bids other than in the form of e-bids shall not be accepted against the above Tender. 3. Tender documents and corrigendum issued from time to time are available on the website at least 14 days in advance of opening tender and may be seen on this website.
[282] **Dy. CE/Bridge Line/HQ**
Travel safely, Avoid footboard travelling

BENGALURU SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT LIMITED
Office of the Deputy General Manager-1,BSWML, 1st Floor, BBMP Building, Thimmaiah Road, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 052
No: DGM-1/BSWML/PR/482/2026-27 **Date:** 22.06.2026
TENDER CANCELLATION NOTIFICATION
(Only through GOK KPP Portal Only)
This is to inform the general public and all concerned that above referred Tender Notification No: DGM-1/BSWML/TEND/10/2026-27, issued by Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML on 05.06.2026 has been cancelled due to technical reasons.
Sd/-
Deputy General Manager-1, BSWML.
DIPR/CP/1299/Shirdi Sai/2026-27

Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises
MSME - TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE - (CDC)
An Autonomous body under Ministry of MSME, Govt of India
1/1 Industrial Area, Phase-III, 22-23/3, Wazirpur, New Delhi-110028
HOW TO SUCCESSFULLY VENTURE INTO WORLD WIDE BUSINESS OF EXPORT-IMPORT
Start Your Own Business
Course Duration 2 Days (ONLINE) Date: 27 & 28 June 2026 Time: 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM
Source Detail: Export Documentation, Market Identification, Launching Business, Locating the resources, Pricing Strategies & Payments, Buyer/Seller Identification, Policies and Schemes, Getting Finance for Export, Foreign Risk Management, Finding top Importing Countries for your products, High Potential Products, Foreign Trade Policy & Schemes, Role of Banks in Trade, Terms & strategies to crack export order successfully, E-Commerce in Export, Anti Dumping Laws, How to find Overseas Buyers, Government Schemes, Letter of credit facilities, EXPORT PRICING AND PAYMENT SYSTEMS, Latest Updates on Export/Import (ISI)
Application of AI for effective Export operations
Fees : Rs.3,540/- (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)
FREE PAYMENT ONLY IN MSME TOC CREDIT ACCOUNT
Coordinator: 8603769900, 9953920498, 8168984069
Government of India certificate will be awarded

TAMIL NADU PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
No.3, TNPSC Road, Chennai-600 003.
SHORT NOTICE
Advertisement No:736 Notification No.05/2026 Dated:23.06.2026
Tamil Nadu Public Service Commission will hold the Preliminary Examination for appointment by direct recruitment to the posts in Combined Civil Services Examination - I (Group I Services) on **06.09.2026 F.N.**
For information relating to educational qualification, age limit, applicability of rule of reservation, scheme of examination, payment of fee, concessions and other details, prospective candidates are advised to refer to the detailed Notification uploaded in the Tamil Nadu Public Service Commission's website www.tnpsc.gov.in.
Secretary
DIPR/562/Display/2026

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
(Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Division)
E-TENDER NOTICE NO: SG-DSE-T-OT-04-26 1.Name of work with its location: Provision of CCTV Cameras at Non-Interlocked Manned LC Gates at different locations over DDU division. 2. **Approx. Cost of the work:** Rs. 4,86,43,985.53/- (Four Crores Eighty Six Lakh Forty Three Thousand Nine Hundred Eighty Five and Paisea Fifty three only). 3. **Earnest Money:** Rs. 9,72,900 (Nine Lakh Seventy Two Thousand Nine Hundred only). 4. **Closing date & time for Submission of e-tendering:** 13-07-2026 up to 12.30 Hrs. 5. **Website particulars where complete details of tender can be seen etc:** www.ireps.gov.in
Divnl. Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central railway, DDU
PR/0440/DDU/S&T/726-27/28

MAHATRANSCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.
SRM E-Tender Notice
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Company Ltd, EHV PC O&M Zone Vashi invites bids through SRM e-Tender in two bid system (Techno-commercial Bid & Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for following works;

RfX No./ Tender No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost
7000040398	Work of EHV Bays strengthening for capacity enhancement of: i) 220kV Navi Mumbai PG I & II Line bays, 2 Nos of TBC bays & Auxiliary bus at 220kV Apta substation ii) 220kV PG & Panchanand Line Bays, 1 No of TBC Bay and Auxiliary bus at 220kV Talaja Substation iii) 220kV Cable replacement work of 220kV Talaja & Kalwa Line Bays at 220kV Panchanand substation under EHV (O&M) Division Panvel	Rs. 1315.48 Lakhs excl. GST Rs. 1552.26 Lakhs incl. GST

E.M.D. in Rs. 13,15,478/-, **Tender Fees:** Rs. 29,500/- including GST, **Sale period:** 23.06.2026 to 14.07.2026, **Last Date of Submission:** 14.07.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs, **Date of opening (Tech. bid):** 14.07.2026 at 15:30 Hrs (if possible).
Contact person: Executive Engineer, EHV PC O&M Zone, Vashi, Phone No. (022) 27666010 (P) / 27665994. For further details please visit to <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
Chief Engineer, EHV PC (O&M), Zone, MSETCL, Vashi

SOUTHERN RAILWAY				
TRIVANDRUM DIVISION		WORKS BRANCH		
E-TENDER NOTICE No. V / W / TVC / 6 / 2026				
Dated: 18.06.2026				
Divisional Railway Manager / Works Branch / Trivandrum Division, Trivandrum-14 for and on behalf of the President of India invites ONLINE tenders for the following works as per tender notice and Complete details are given in our e-tender portal www.ireps.gov.in				
Sl. No.	Description	Approx. Value ₹ in lakhs	Earnest Money Deposit ₹	Period of Completion in Months
1	ZONE A-From KM. 1.850 to KM.33.860 (VTK & TCR STNS BOTH INCLUSIVE) & TCR-GUV LINE KM 0.000 TO 22.630 (INCL GUV) Thiruch permanent way section.	71.92	143800	Twelve
2	ZONE B-From KM. 33.860 TO KM.68.725 (TCR & KRAN STNS BOTH EXCLUSIVE) Chalakudi permanent way section.	70.46	140900	Twelve
3	ZONE C-From KM. 68.725 TO KM.102.050 (KRAN INCL & ERN EXCLUSIVE) Always permanent way section.	84.35	168700	Twelve
4	ZONE D-From KM. 102.05 TO KM.106.85, FROM KM.0.000 TO KM.13.520 (ERN, ERS C & D CABIN INCL & KFE EXCLUSIVE) From KM.0.000 TO KM. 8.170 (ERS INCL & KUMM INCLUSIVE)	125.39	250800	Twelve
5	ZONE D1-Ernakulam - Diesel shed, trip shed, Ernakulam Marshalling Coaching depot, Ernakulam Marshalling Goods G station & colony, Irumpam station & colony, Mattachery - Cochin Harbour Terminus station & colony, Excl:Ernakulam Jn. (KM. 106.85 TO KM.114.60 IN ERS-CHTS LINE).	72.43	144900	Twelve
6	ZONE E-From KM.13.520 TO KM.96.230 (KFE INCL & CNGR INCLUSIVE) in Kottayam Pway section.	130.18	260400	Twelve
7	ZONE Q-From KM. 8.170 TO KM.177.30 (VAK INCL & TVP EXCLUSIVE) in ALLP, MVLK, QLN Pway Sections	253.67	507300	Twelve
8	ZONE I-From KM. 177.300 TO KM.217.000 (VAK INCL & TVP EXCLUSIVE) in Varkala Pway section	54.41	108800	Twelve
9	ZONE J3-Trivandrum Coaching depot, Railway hospital / Pettah, TVP station & pettah colony (KM.217.000 TO 219.000)	89.02	178100	Twelve
10	ZONE J1-TVC station & service building, Divisional office, poolapura colony & Thampanoor colony (KM.219.000 TO KM.222.000)	127.63	255300	Twelve
11	ZONE J2-From KM. 222.000 TO KM.287.100 (TVC EXCL & NJT EXCLUSIVE) TVC-Pway section	64.62	129200	Twelve
12	ZONE K-From KM.287.100 TO KM.362.600 (NJT EXCL & MP INCLUSIVE) From KM.0.000 TO KM.15.510 (NCJ-CAPE LINE) Nagercoil Pway section	124.74	249500	Twelve
13	Assistant Divisional Engineer / Kollam (ADEN/QLN) Sub Division (Zone - Tr-4, Tr-5 & Tr-12) - Execution of works and supply of materials for Track maintenance	143.24	286500	Twelve
14	Allied works to accommodate New UPWL (Under floor wheel lathe) at TVC.	58.38	116800	Twelve
15	DEN/South Jurisdiction:- Supply of welding portion 52 Kg and 60 Kg and supervision of welding.	439.48	879000	Twelve
16	SSE/WQLN section - Strengthening and painting of platform shelters and other steel structures under SSE/WQLN	232.78	465600	Twelve
17	Supplying drinking water to TVC & TVCN, RH/TVP & TVP Quarters, Divisional Office, and VAK Railway Stations for the purpose of coach watering for a period of twelve months.	132.57	265100	Twelve
18	TVC Division:- Provision of Tactile Paving at Stations under ADEN/ERS Sub Division	237.07	474100	Twelve
19	SSE/WKTYM Section- Proposed essential repairs to Foot Over Bridges	138.15	276300	Twelve
20	Kottayam (KTYM) P.Way Section (Zone-TR-6) - Execution of works and supply of materials for track maintenance for the year 2025-26.	45.00	90000	Eight
21	Sr. DEN/North Jurisdiction -> Supply of welding portion 60 Kg-R 260 grade, 52 kg, equipments and supervision of welding (Balance work)	113.34	226700	Twelve
22	ERS - KYTM - KYJ Section - Pro. Reconstruction of Exp. Bridge No. 297 (1x4.57m PSC slab) as 1 x 6.10m RCC box at km. 58/000 - 100 between Ettumanur and Kottayam stations.	150.62	301200	Twelve
23	TVC Division:- Provision of Tactile Paving at Stations under ADEN/NCJ Jurisdiction	483.87	967800	Nine
24	TVC Division:- Provision of Tactile Paving at Stations under ADEN/QLN Jurisdiction	239.58	479200	Nine
25	TVC Division:- Provision of Tactile Paving at Stations under ADEN/TVC Jurisdiction	105.85	211700	Six
26	TVC Division:- Provision of Tactile Paving at Stations under ADEN/TCR Sub Division	906.88	1813800	Eighteen
Tender Closing date and time: SI No.: 1 to 26 on 10.07.2026 at 11.00 hrs				
Note: It is the responsibility of the tenderer to check any Corrigendum issued for any correction or modifications uploaded subsequently in website; the same shall be taken in to account while submitting.				
Divisional Railway Manager (Works), Trivandrum - 14				

THE HINDU
OPPORTUNITIES

Over 1500 Jobs in today's issue

GENERAL
SBI
State Bank of India
Central Recruitment & Promotion Department
Corporate Centre, Mumbai
Phone: 022-22820427
RECRUITMENT OF PROBATIONARY OFFICERS
Applications are invited from eligible Indian citizens for appointment as Probationary Officer in State Bank of India.
NUMBER OF VACANCIES: 1500
Eligibility criteria (age, qualification etc.), requisite fee and other details, along-with a link for online submission of application and online payment of application fee, are available on to Bank's website <https://sbi.bank.in/careers/current-openings> under Advertisement No. CRPD/PO/2026-27/09. Candidates are advised to go through the detailed advertisement and ensure their eligibility and other details before applying and remitting fee.
• **DATE FOR ONLINE REGISTRATION & PAYMENT OF FEE: 18.06.2026 TO 08.07.2026**
For any query, please write to us through the link "CONTACT US" which is available on Bank's official website mentioned above.
Place: Mumbai
Date: 18.06.2026
General Manager (RP & PM)

SRU SR UNIVERSITY **nirf** RANKING 2025 **91** ALL INDIA RANK IN ENGINEERING CATEGORY
Walk-In Interview for Prof./ Assoc. Prof./ Asst. Prof.
Positions in the Following Disciplines:
CSE, ECE, EEE, English, Management & Psychology on 30th June 2026
Eligibility: Ph.D. with SCIE-Indexed Publications.
Benefits: Compensation among the best in the country, laptop, PF, medical insurance, research incentives, seed grant, professional allowance, and children's education fee concession at SR Group of Institutions.
(For deserving CSE Candidates from Premier Institutions - Minimum Salary: ₹ 18.0 LPA)
We are also looking for suitable candidates for an Industry Engagement role.
Minimum Qualification: Postgraduate degree with a strong industry network and relevant experience.
Role Requirements:
* Good interpersonal, social and communication skills.
* Identify, engage, and onboard industry partners for internships.
* Coordinate internship activities within the assigned zone.
Locations: Bangalore, Hyderabad, Chennai, NCR, Ahmedabad, Pune, and Mumbai.
Note: Candidates should send their resume to hr@sr.edu.in by **28th June 2026, 5:00 pm.**
SR UNIVERSITY, Warangal, Telangana, India www.sru.edu.in

To Advertise in The Hindu Opportunities column, Please contact, Nagaraj. V
Email: nagaraj.v@thehindu.co.in
Ph: 98415 71594

NARAYAN
Medical College & Hospital
(Gopal Narayan Singh University)
Jamuahar, Sasaram, Rohtas, Bihar - 821305
RECRUITMENT NOTICE
Applications are invited from suitable candidates for the following teaching positions:
➤ **ASSISTANT PROFESSOR, SENIOR RESIDENT**
RADIOLOGY, OBS & GYNE, GENERAL MEDICINE, PHARMACOLOGY, ANATOMY, PHYSIOLOGY, PATHOLOGY
➤ **PROFESSOR** ORTHOPAEDICS, DVL, PATHOLOGY.
Interested Candidates may share their updated Resume-CV with us at Email: office.narayanmedical@gmail.com, Contact No: 85780 03021

VIT-AP UNIVERSITY
Apply Knowledge. Improve Life!
Mentoring the future generations
VIT - AP is looking for a distinguished academicians with the highest level of competence, integrity, ethical standards, and connectivity with national and international institutions, for the position of
VICE CHANCELLOR
The applicant should possess adequate administrative expertise with a minimum of 10 years of experience as Professor in a University system or 10 years of experience in an equivalent position in a reputed research and/or academic administrative organization as per the University Grant Commission (UGC) norms.
For more details, please visit www.vitap.ac.in
Interested candidates are requested to apply confidentially, enclosing their CV and appropriate supporting documents to the following email ID vc.selection@vitap.ac.in
latest by **08.07.2026**

A CH-CHE

12 YEARS OF MARITIME TRANSFORMATION

SAGAR SE SAMRIDDHI JALMARG SE VIKAS

A nation shaped by its waters, rising towards a bold new future

“ We Indians are the inheritors of a glorious maritime heritage, and it is the endeavour of our Government to restore India's position of eminence in the global maritime sector.

~ **Narendra Modi**, Prime Minister

12 YEARS BY THE NUMBERS

1,668 MMT

Total cargo handled at Indian ports, a 59% rise from 1,052 MMT

2,818 MMT

Total port capacity,
an 81% rise from
1,561 MMT

218 MMT

Cargo on national waterways, a 652% rise from just 29 MMT

3.23 LAKH

Indian seafarers deployed globally, up 155% from 1.27 lakh. Women seafarers grew 340%

₹26,583 CR

Major port annual revenue, up 126% from ₹11,760 Cr

India — World No. 1 in Ship Recycling

Maritime India Vision 2030 target achieved five years ahead of schedule

PILLARS OF TRANSFORMATION

PORTS

BIGGER & SMARTER

- **₹15,000 Cr Annual maritime CAPEX, up 362% since 2014.**
- **PPP investment alone surged 836% to ₹8,000 Cr.**
- **Coastal cargo more than doubled, from 74 to 177 MMT.**



A REVOLUTION UNDERWAY

- **111 National Waterways** notified, up from 5 in 2014.
- Operational waterways grew from 3 to 32.
- Over **10 crore** passengers now travel by inland waterways every year.



RISING TO THE WORLD STAGE

- **Mega Shipbuilding push: ~ ₹70,000 Cr**
- **New dry dock at Cochin Shipyard inaugurated 2024.**
- **Domestic fleet acquisition plan: 437 vessels worth ₹2.2 lakh Cr.**



CLEANER SEAS, CLEANER RIVERS

- Renewable energy use at major ports **up 30x** since 2014.
- **India's first hydrogen-powered ferry** launched at Varanasi, December 2025
- **Green Tug Transition Programme** targets zero-emission tugs at all major ports by 2040.



LANDMARK PROJECTS

- ➔ **Jal Marg Vikas Project** — Transforming NW-1 from Haldia to Varanasi, ₹5,061 Cr
- ➔ **Jogighopa IWT Terminal, Assam** — New gateway for Northeast India's trade corridor
- ➔ **Mumbai Marina** — 424 yacht berths, ₹887 Cr, India's first world-class marina, 2028
- ➔ **Vadhvan Port, Maharashtra** — India's future largest container port, ₹76,000 Cr investment
- ➔ **National Maritime Heritage Complex, Lothal** — Envisioned as the world's largest maritime museum
- ➔ **Tuna Tekra Container Terminal, Gujarat** — 2.19 million TEU annual capacity

REFORMS & MILESTONES

- ➔ **3 Indian ports in Global Top 30** — 7 in Global Top 100 (World Bank Container Port Performance Index 2025)
- ➔ **Sagarmala Programme** — 7,100+ km of port connectivity infrastructure across India
- ➔ **11 landmark Acts enacted** — including the Merchant Shipping Act 2025 and Indian Ports Act 2025, replacing colonial-era laws
- ➔ **One Nation One Port Process** — Over 39% reduction in documentation transactions at all 12 major ports
- ➔ **Sea cruise passengers up 328%** — from 1.08 lakh to 4.62 lakh
- ➔ **Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047** — 300+ initiatives targeting 10,000 MMTPA port capacity

12
Saal

Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke

Propelling India's Vikas Yatra through Maritime Excellence

www.shipmin.gov.in

Maritime India Vision 2030 | Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047 | Sagarmala Programme

The Andhra Pradesh Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu, on Tuesday approved a slew of key decisions aimed at accelerating investments and advancing the development of Amaravati as the State capital. The Cabinet gave its nod to investment proposals worth ₹34,000 crore that was earlier cleared by the State Investment Promotion Board (SIPB).

Some in the Karnataka BJP feel that Mr. Kumaraswamy made that move at the behest of an anti-Vijayendra faction in the State unit to expose the flaws in the latter's leadership of the State unit.

Air Quality Color: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_x: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. It can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease



भारतीय सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान भागलपुर

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY BHAGALPUR

(An Institute of National Importance under
Ministry of Education, Govt. of India)

Sabour, Bhagalpur-813210, Bihar



ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE RECRUITMENT OF FACULTY POSITIONS

Advt No. IIITBH/ADVT/RECT/2026/09

Indian Institute of Information Technology Bhagalpur (IIIT Bhagalpur) is an Institute of National Importance set up by Ministry of Education (MoE), Govt. of India in Public-Private-Partnership (PPP) mode. The institute offers B.Tech, M. Tech and Ph.D. program (s) in the Computer Science & Engineering, Mechatronics & Automation Engineering, Electronics & Communication Engineering, and Mathematics & Computing. The Institute invites applications from Indian nationals in the prescribed format for Faculty Positions as per following details:

Sl. No.	Name of Post	# No. of Post	Category	Pay Matrix & Basic Pay	Application Fee for UR/OBC/EWS	Application Fee for SC/ST/PwBD	Application Fee for UR/OBC/EWS Candidates applying from abroad	Application Fee for SC/ST/PwBD Candidates applying from abroad
01	Assistant Professor, Grade I	21	UR-10 OBC-05 SC-04 ST-01 EWS-01	Level-12 of the Pay Matrix of the 7th Central Pay Commission	₹ 2,000/-	₹ 1,000/-	₹ 5,000/-	₹ 2,500/-
02	Assistant Professor, Grade II (to be appointed on contract basis)			Level-10 of the Pay Matrix of the 7th Central Pay Commission	₹ 2,000/-	₹ 1,000/-	₹ 5,000/-	₹ 2,500/-

Note: Reservation for PwBD candidates shall be applicable as per the Govt. of India norms.

The last date of submission of online application form is **15.07.2026 till 23:55 hrs** and hard copy of application form along with all the enclosures is **22.07.2026 till 17:00 hrs** through **Registered Post/Speed Post only**. Please visit www.iiitbh.ac.in for more information.

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

PR- 006464 (Sci. & Tech.) 2026-27
Registrar

नरेश से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

UTTAR PRADESH

POWERING A SKILLED & EMPLOYED FUTURE

Uttar Pradesh is advancing a new development paradigm anchored in transparent recruitment, investment-driven growth, youth empowerment and expanding livelihood opportunities, while steadily building world-class sports infrastructure and stronger pathways for skills, employment and excellence.



UTTAR PRADESH BY THE NUMBERS

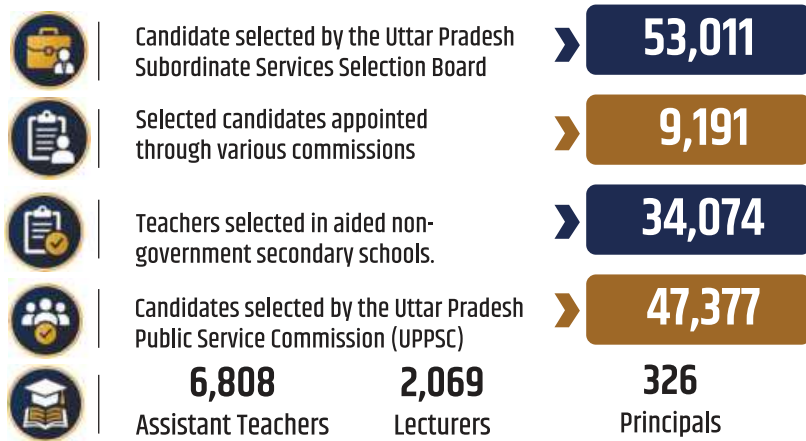


TRANSPARENT GOVERNANCE & PUBLIC EMPLOYMENT

Recruitment Reforms

- More than 9 lakh youth provided government employment through various commissions and recruitment boards under a fair and transparent recruitment process.
- An Outsourcing Service Corporation has been initiated to strengthen employee security and transparency.
- OTR (One-Time Registration) introduced in UPPSC for convenience and transparency.
- Interviews removed from direct recruitment for Group 'B' (Non-Gazetted) and Group 'C' posts to strengthen merit-based selection.

Recruitment & Selection Outcomes (2017-2025)



Validity of the Preliminary Eligibility Test (PET) has been extended to three years.

Inclusion & Representation Framework

- 10% vertical reservation implemented in state services for the Economically Weaker Sections (EWS).
- 20% horizontal reservation for Agniveers in UP Police, PAC and Fire Services.
- 5% reservation in Group 'B', 'C' and 'D' posts for Ex-servicemen.
- Provisions for appointing dependents of deceased employee in other departments where appointment is not possible in the concerned department.
- Departments required to comply with reservation norms prior to recruitment requisitions.
- Strengthened public examination system through the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act.

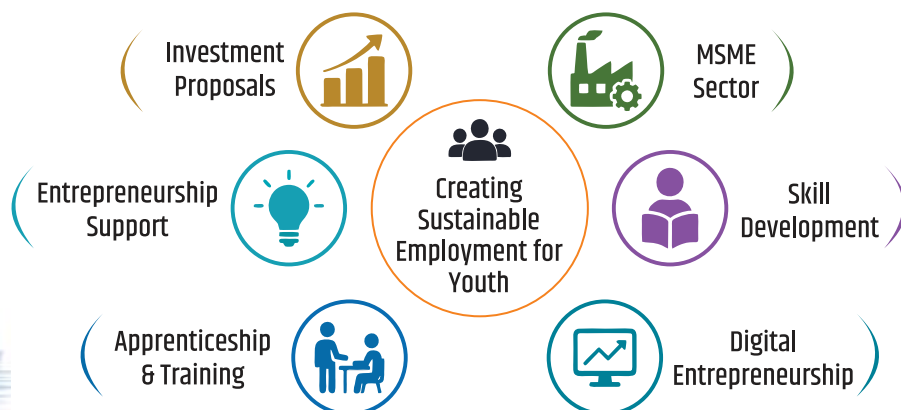
INVESTMENT, ENTERPRISE & EMPLOYMENT GROWTH

Employment Engine Of Uttar Pradesh

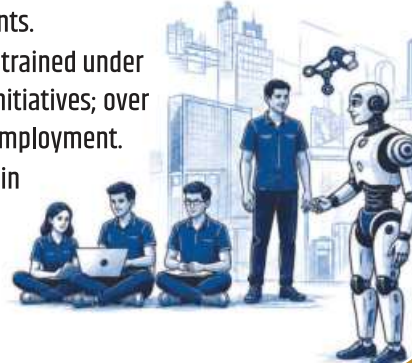
- Over the past 9 years, investment proposals worth ₹50 lakh crore have created employment opportunities for more than 1.10 crore youth.
 - Investment proposals worth ₹15 lakh crore have been grounded, generating 60 lakh employment opportunities.
 - More than 3.11 crore people employed in the MSME sector.
- 



Employment Creation Ecosystem

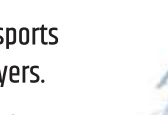
 Skills, Training & Industry Readiness

- Under the Chief Minister Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme, more than 1 lakh youth have been registered in industries and establishments.
 - More than 25.80 lakh youth trained under various skill development initiatives; over 10.20 lakh youth provided employment.
 - Students are being trained in Industry 4.0 domains including Artificial Intelligence, Robotics.
- 



SPORTS DEVELOPMENT & TALENT PATHWAYS

Sports Development

- Connect of “One District – One Sport” Scheme.
 - Payment of ₹25,000 per month honorarium to coaches in 75 districts.
 - Provision of kits and sports equipment for 30 players.
 - In FY 2025-26, kits were distributed to 789 players (434 boys and 355 girls) across 21 sports.
- 



Athlete Recognition

Olympic Games	➤ Gold Medal – ₹6 crore	
	➤ Silver Medal – ₹4 crore	
	➤ Bronze Medal – ₹2 crore	
Asian Games Incentive	➤ Gold Medal – ₹3 crore	
	➤ Silver Medal – ₹1.5 crore	
	➤ Bronze Medal – ₹75 lakh	
Commonwealth Games & World Cup-Related Competitions	➤ Gold Medal – ₹1.5 crore	
	➤ Silver Medal – ₹75 lakh	
	➤ Bronze Medal – ₹50 lakh	

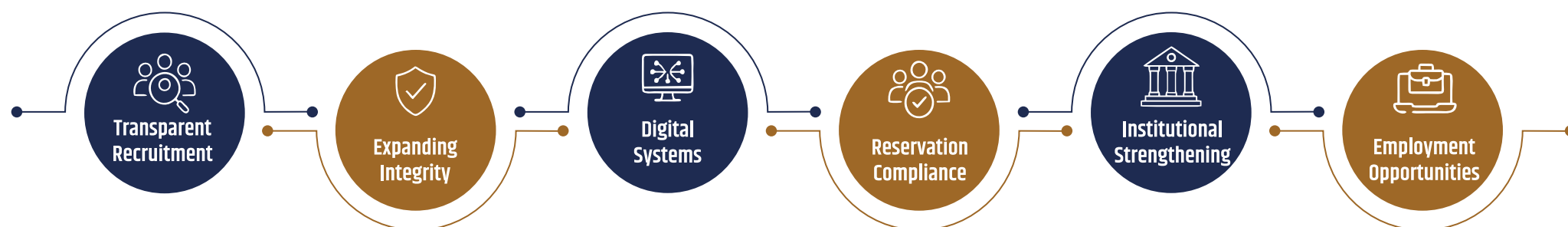
State athletes participating in the Olympics receive ₹10 lakh, while Commonwealth and Asian Games participants receive ₹5 lakh as encouragement support.

Sports Infrastructure Expansion

- Construction of international cricket stadium in Gorakhpur and at Varanasi is in progress.
 - Extensive development of stadiums, multipurpose sports halls, swimming pools and gym facilities across the state.
 - Development of sports grounds in every village is underway.
- 



UTTAR PRADESH SPORTS ECOSYSTEM



Towards a more skilled, empowered and opportunity-rich Uttar Pradesh.

With transparent recruitment, investment-driven growth, stronger institutions and expanding livelihood opportunities, Uttar Pradesh is creating a workforce prepared for the demands of a changing economy.



Evident distress

Stress from the West Asia crisis has revealed economic pain

As the resolution process of the West Asia crisis drags on, an increasing number of economic metrics are exposing key weaknesses in the Indian economy. Many of these existed before the crisis broke out in late February and are now becoming apparent as the economy faces stress. The latest data on the Index of Eight Core Industries show that these sectors cumulatively grew just 0.5% in May 2026, the second-lowest in 21 months. It would have been easy to pass this off as a war-related impact, but the data also show that the index grew by an almost equally anaemic 1.1% over the course of the entire financial year 2025-26. What remains a concern is that the domestic crude oil and natural gas sectors continued their multi-year streaks of contractions in May as well. By this time, the third month of the conflict, oil prices had settled somewhat lower than their April peaks. As a result, oil imports by oil marketing companies began rising once again to meet domestic demand. A strategic goal continues to be missed here. While imported oil can be used to meet demand, domestic production should nevertheless be ramped up to fill strategic reserves. This reserve oil, even of inferior quality, can be released in times of shortage. The same holds true for natural gas. With natural gas imports and domestic production contracting, it followed that the fertilizer sector would also contract. The good news, however, is that the contraction – of 0.9% in May 2026 – was much lower than it was even two months earlier. In any case, what impact the ‘super El Niño’ will have on fertilizer demand is still uncertain.

Coal production, too, contracted by the most in nearly a year. As the summer continues to heat up, electricity generation will increasingly have to rely on variable renewable sources or costly imported coal. Notably, the core sectors are not the only ones revealing economic distress. The latest Goods and Services Tax (GST) revenue data too show that domestic economic activity seems to be slowing. Revenues from domestic transactions contracted 2.6% in May 2026. The government argues that this is because of a one-time windfall transfer it received in May last year. Even so, the average growth of domestic GST revenue over the last six months was just 3.1%, lower than in 2025-26 and the year before that. This is not a supply issue, since merchandise exports hit a record high in May 2026. It is a demand problem, as low real wage growth meets rising inflation to squeeze wallets. These are all distressing signals even as India enters a deficient monsoon. Trade deals are no substitute for hard-hitting reforms.

Downing streak

Labour needs a progressive makeover to survive the far-right onslaught

Keir Starmer entered Downing Street in July 2024 with a landslide victory. Ending 14 years of Conservative rule, marked by Brexit and the chaos that followed, he promised to build a government for all and bridge the widening trust deficit between the public and the political elite. Less than two years later, the former lawyer who took pride in taking Labour back to the political centre after the brief left-wing interlude of Jeremy Corbyn, has resigned amid mounting public discontent and growing revolt within the Labour party. Mr. Starmer rode an anti-Tory wave but soon found the public turning against him over his lapses in judgment and slow economic progress. His uncharismatic, technocratic centrism failed to withstand the rapid changes shaping British politics at a time when far-right parties were surging across continental Europe. The tide began to turn after revelations that Peter Mandelson, Mr. Starmer’s choice as Britain’s Ambassador to Washington, had links to the late convicted paedophile Jeffrey Epstein. Pressure mounted after Labour lost local elections in England and polls in Wales and Scotland. When Andy Burnham, Labour’s ‘King in the North’, won the Makerfield byelection and returned to Westminster, Mr. Starmer’s fate was sealed, and he resigned on June 22.

Under Mr. Starmer, the U.K. saw modest improvements in key economic indicators. Its economy began growing faster than those of its G7 peers, while inflation remained broadly under control despite conflicts in Europe and Asia. New laws strengthened workers rights, and statutory minimum wage rates were raised. Yet, these incremental gains were insufficient to satisfy an electorate that had given Labour a commanding mandate. Mr. Starmer proved largely ineffective in addressing the economic anxieties of the working-class communities that delivered his majority, or the cultural grievances Reform UK had been amplifying. Labour MPs started turning against him, making it difficult for him to continue in office. Mr. Burnham, who belongs to the soft left camp of Labour, is expected to be elected as the party’s new leader and the next Prime Minister – and at a moment when the old bipolar consensus of British politics is breaking down. Reform is no longer a fringe force. With the conservatives, Britain’s traditional vehicle of the right, in deep decline, Reform is emerging as the second pole. Mr. Burnham should recognise that the Starmerite centrism is unlikely to withstand the onslaught of a far-right cultural politics entrenched in English nationalism. He must unite a fractious party around a progressive economic and foreign policy agenda and build a government that works for all while standing firmly on the right side of global issues. If Labour fails to reconnect with its core values and social base, it risks losing even the constituencies that have long sustained it.

Public health policies, like other public policies, are crucial in determining the overall health of the population and are an important contributor to a nation seeking to reap the benefits of its demographic dividend. One of the major claims of health policies in recent years has been the achievement of universal health coverage (UHC), a novel idea that seeks to ensure that every individual has access to needed health services without suffering financial hardship. Yet, populist ideas often dominate public policy despite evidence to the contrary, as seen in the case of publicly funded health insurance schemes. The changing nature of public health policy in recent years is particularly concerning, not only because it has often failed to be evidence-based, but also because of its inability to guarantee even minimal health benefits to the population.

More troubling is the failure of public health policies to improve access to health care at a time when such access is deteriorating significantly owing to rising costs in the private sector and poor quality in the public sector. Two recent government initiatives – the Ayushman Bharat Health and Wellness Centres and the Digital Health Mission – illustrate these inadequacies.

The interpretation

The Ayushman Bharat Health and Wellness Centres, introduced as a policy initiative in 2018, were intended to strengthen health infrastructure. What eventually happened, however, was that the names and identities of grassroots-level institutions – namely, the health sub-centres (SCs), primary health centres (PHCs), and community health centres (CHCs) – were altered by mandatorily adding “Health and Wellness Centre” as a prefix. The identity of these grassroots institutions and their mandates have evolved over time based on their roles within the district health system. The use of a common prefix has created considerable ambiguity among health professionals and policymakers regarding their actual mandate. Another consequence of the “health and wellness” approach has been a shift in focus from population health outcomes to individual well-being. The major challenge in using well-being as an outcome measure lies in the elusive and subjective nature of the concept itself.

A historical inquiry into the concept of wellness reveals that it was initially used to denote the absence of disease and was often contrasted with illness. It was also frequently used interchangeably with health. During the 1950s, the wellness movement popularised the idea of positive well-being by conceptualising health beyond its biological dimensions. The mental cure model similarly emphasised the psychological and spiritual aspects of healing. Influenced by these developments, the World



Mathew George

Professor with the Department of Public Health Sciences, Central University of Kerala, Kasaragod, Kerala

Access to curative care and stronger institutions must anchor India’s health policy

Health Organization (WHO) defined health as not merely the absence of disease, thereby promoting the notion of positive well-being. Over time, wellness expanded beyond physiological health to include mental, spiritual, social and environmental dimensions, offering a more holistic understanding of health. In public health, however, the emphasis shifted towards health promotion – a population-based approach that recognises how social, economic and environmental conditions shape people’s ability to adopt healthy behaviours.

Another reason for preferring health promotion over wellness was the greater rigour and feasibility associated with measuring the former. There are no universally accepted measures of well-being at the population level, as the concept is inherently individualistic and deeply subjective. Unlike health promotion, the concept of wellness places the primary responsibility on individuals, assuming that they possess the capacity and opportunity to modify their health-related choices. In doing so, it often underestimates the structural and social determinants that shape health outcomes.

The individualisation of health

The shift from population health status to individual well-being is a consequence of the changing wellness narrative brought by the public health policy. The implication is that health status, which was previously assessed through unmet needs in preventive, promotive, curative and rehabilitative care – including access to basic services such as drinking water, food and nutrition, chronic disease management, emergency care, and maternal and child health services – is increasingly being replaced by the aspiration to achieve individual well-being. This shift in focus has contributed to the rise of health coaches and the proliferation of social media messages promoting individual well-being, often under the banner of public health.

When health outcomes are framed primarily in terms of individual well-being, there is a risk of failing to systematically capture a wide range of unmet health needs that remain significant for the population. The broader narrative increasingly suggests that the achievement of individual well-being is the ultimate objective of health and wellness centres. This presents a serious challenge. As the well-known principle in management states, “If you cannot measure it, you cannot improve it”. Given the inherently subjective nature of well-being, an excessive policy focus on this outcome may undermine the ability to evaluate health systems effectively and address concrete deficiencies in health care access and service delivery.

Another major public health policy initiative of recent years is the Ayushman Bharat Digital Health Mission (ABDHM), whose principal

objective is to create a digital repository of health information for every individual through a unique health ID, known as the ABHA card. In addition, the mission seeks to maintain registries of health facilities, health-care professionals and information related to health insurance. However, an information portal containing health records and details of health infrastructure cannot, by itself, address the challenges posed by inadequate access to health care. Nor does it justify the annual budget of around ₹300 crore to the ABDHM in the absence of measurable outcomes.

Factors behind inadequate access to care

It is well established that inadequate access to health care in India stems from the unaffordability of care in the private sector and the lack of quality health-care facilities in the public sector. Merely creating databases of individual health records, health facilities and health-care professionals cannot improve access to health care. If the argument is that information is the first step towards strengthening the health system, there exists a substantial body of reports and datasets that provide such information.

The more pertinent question is how information contained in an individual’s health record, through an ABHA card, can guarantee access to health care when health-care infrastructure remains grossly inadequate and unaffordable for large sections of the population. Even if every individual in a district possesses an ABHA card and all health facilities and health-care professionals are digitally mapped, the delivery of health care still requires a robust institutional mechanism. Unfortunately, the ABDHM, as currently designed, has little to say about the provisioning of care. It primarily generates information on individuals, facilities and health-care professionals, all of which continue to operate largely in silos.

It is therefore difficult to identify a compelling public health rationale for this scale of data generation. What is missing from current policy initiatives are concrete measures to strengthen public health-care institutions, as envisaged under India’s three-tier health-care system. Instead, these institutions continue to weaken in many parts of the country.

For most people, access to curative care constitutes an immediate and pressing need. Only after these basic health-care requirements are met can individuals meaningfully engage with preventive and promotive health interventions. When public health policies fail to recognise people’s felt needs, they risk becoming mere vehicles for advancing the priorities of policymakers and health-care providers rather than addressing the actual concerns of the population.

The views expressed are personal

India’s next challenge — from invention to global scale



Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw

Executive Chairperson, Biocon Limited

The country must transform innovation into globally dominant technology enterprises

despite its innovation, the supporting ecosystem was absent. Venture capital, software platforms, component supply chains and consumer markets were not mature enough to help it achieve global scale. A few years later, Apple transformed personal computing through the iPhone and built one of the world’s most valuable technology ecosystems. The lesson is clear: being first matters little if you cannot scale.

India has seen similar patterns elsewhere. It developed early expertise in computing, telecommunications and electronics. Yet, many pioneering initiatives remained prototypes, pilots or public-sector achievements rather than globally dominant businesses.

Models of success

Fortunately, history also offers examples of success. India’s pharmaceutical industry evolved into a globally competitive manufacturing powerhouse, making the country the pharmacy of the world and a leading vaccine producer. India also developed indigenous supercomputing capabilities through the PARAM programme. More recently, Aadhaar and UPI have shown how technology platforms designed for scale can transform a nation. Scale creates ecosystems, ecosystems create industries, and industries create global leadership.

Today, India stands at another technological inflection point. AI, quantum computing and space technologies are likely to shape the next half-century, just as semiconductors and software shaped the last. India already possesses significant strengths in software engineering and digital infrastructure. The challenge now is to build globally scalable AI products and platforms. The emergence of DeepSeek showed that technological leadership is not only about building the largest models. It is also about making intelligence cheaper and more accessible. The AI race may ultimately be won by those who make intelligence affordable, ubiquitous and widely available.

India is uniquely positioned to lead this

movement. Just as UPI democratised financial inclusion, India should aspire to democratise intelligence through low-cost, energy-efficient AI models that can serve billions of people.

Quantum computing presents another opportunity. Rather than merely replicating existing approaches, India should focus on reducing the cost of quantum infrastructure and developing practical applications in health care, materials science, climate modelling and drug discovery.

The same should extend to space. The successes of Chandrayaan and Mangalyaan proved that frugal innovation can coexist with world-class ambition. As computing demands escalate globally, concepts such as space-based data centres powered by continuous solar energy are attracting serious attention. India should not merely participate in these conversations; it should lead them. We should ask bold questions about orbital computing infrastructure, space-based AI platforms or even data centres and quantum communication networks.

These ideas may seem futuristic today. But so did semiconductors, smartphones and AI when they first emerged.

Stopping too soon

The deeper lesson from SCL, ECIL and Simputer is not that India failed, but that it often stopped too soon. We celebrated technological capability before building the ecosystems needed for global scale. The next phase of India’s technological journey must combine self-reliance with global ambition. The challenge is no longer merely to invent; it is to build, scale, commercialise and create enterprises that can compete globally.

India has already demonstrated world-class scientific and engineering capabilities. The opportunity now is to translate that ingenuity into globally competitive industries that shape the technologies of the future.

The countries that lead tomorrow may not be those that invent first, but those that scale best. This time, India must do both.

science and medicine across India. Tu Youyou, who was awarded the 2015 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for synthesising a life-saving antimalarial based on cues from traditional Chinese medicine, affirmed that cultural legacies inspire scientific work. “Let us

reach to a greater height to appreciate Chinese culture and find the beauty and treasure in the territory of traditional Chinese medicine!” she said.

Dr. G.L. Krishna, Bengaluru

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

No compromise on safety

It is deeply unfortunate that fires continue to engulf commercial complexes across India, with faulty electrical wiring and leakages emerging as perennial culprits. The tragedy in Lucknow’s Aliganj area (Front page, June 23) once again exposes the

criminal negligence that has become all too routine. Wiring standards for commercial establishments remain outdated, poorly enforced and often bypassed through corruption or sheer incompetence. Agencies responsible for public safety — including the electrical

inspectorate, urban development authorities, fire services and local municipal bodies — must be held accountable. A nationwide review and comprehensive overhaul of wiring standards is urgently needed. A. Thirugnanasambantham, Coimbatore

Sushruta statue

It was gratifying to read that a bronze statue of Maharishi Sushruta — revered as the Father of Surgery — has been unveiled at The Royal College of Surgeons of Edinburgh. It would be truly inspirational to have well-sculpted statues of the sage surgeon in centres of

India’s patchy industrial climate strategy

The inevitable conclusion emerging from the ambitious targets set up by the government’s Make-in-India, Viksit Bharat (2047) and net-zero emissions (2070) commitments is that industrial decarbonisation is central to India’s long-term climate goals.

As the economy grows, both existing and emerging manufacturing segments expand, fuelling a steep rise in energy demand. Balancing this industrial growth on the one hand and population-driven consumption demand on the other with national emission reduction objectives requires highly targeted policies. The recently submitted First Biennial Transparency Report (BTRI) by India to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change provides a detailed account of national emissions. The report discloses that in 2022, over 20% of India’s total emissions stemmed directly from the industrial sector. Specifically, it shows that the fuel consumption in manufacturing industries and construction accounts for 13% of total emissions, while industrial processes and product use accounts for another 9%. This clearly demonstrates how much manufacturing activities contribute to the overall carbon footprint, a trend that has remained consistent over time.



Shifali Goyal
Research Associate, Centre for Social and Economic Progress and PhD Scholar, Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT)



Debashis Chakraborty
Professor, IIIT Kolkata. Views are personal

petroleum refining, pulp and paper, textiles, and chlor-alkali. The other four industries, which include thermal power plants, railways, DISCOMs and commercial buildings, will continue under the PAT scheme.

While these schemes set benchmarks, encourage energy efficiency, and reduce emission intensity, there is a clear gap in how mitigation planning is envisioned across Indian industries. These policies are designed almost entirely for well-defined, traditional heavy-emitting sectors such as cement, steel, fertilizers, refineries, and textiles. However, they de facto overlook a massive proportion of industrial emissions, specifically those generated by fuel consumption in, what India’s emission inventory classifies as, “non-specific industries”.

A careful analysis of emissions data for India’s manufacturing industries and construction sector for the latest reported year, 2020, reveals a crucial puzzle that needs to be solved urgently. The explicitly specified major industrial sectors accounted for slightly more than 55% of the total emissions generated from manufacturing industries and construction. Conversely, more than 40% of those sectoral emissions were caused by the “non-specific industries” category alone. A similar pattern has been seen in 2014, 2016, and 2019 as well, as per the detailed emission inventory available on NITI Aayog’s India Climate and Energy Dashboard. To sum up, the classification of sectors in India’s emission inventory reflects that a surprisingly large volume of emissions falls under a single, vague heading of “non-specific industries”.

The point of concern is that the scope of mitigation policies in India has relied on an enforcement and incentive-based structure around specific, identifiable sectors. For instance, some of the explicitly identified sectors in the emission inventory,

such as power, cement, non-ferrous metals, chemicals, and textiles, are covered by mitigation measures such as PAT and CCTS. Yet, a major part of industrial emissions remains in an administrative grey area, with serious implications for India’s broader industrial climate strategy. As this 40% block lacks specific sub-sectoral definitions, the various industries clustered therein effectively fall outside the primary scope of both PAT and CCTS. They are not subject to the same energy efficiency mandates or emission-reduction targets as industries such as steel or cement, despite their contributions to the emissions load. This policy gap keeps a significant portion of the country’s industrial base out of the green transition.

Need to identify industries

For India to successfully decouple its industrial growth from greenhouse gas emissions, the next phase of its national climate strategy needs more transparent, disaggregated data. This must begin with breaking down the existing “non-specific industries” in the emission inventory. For timely realisation of the net-zero emissions target, policymakers need to urgently focus on identifying exactly which sub-sectors contribute to these 40% emissions, how their specific energy consumption patterns are evolving, and the part in the process chain where emissions are primarily concentrated.

Transparency in climate reporting is often framed as an international obligation, a way to prove to the world that a nation is effectively traversing the path for honouring its pledges. But the real value of transparency is deeply domestic. It provides policymakers with an appropriate level of clarity to monitor exactly where the interventions are heading and where there is scope for course correction. Therefore, to build a low-carbon economy, exact knowledge on these passive outliers is non-negotiable.

A plausible rewiring in Karnataka

Private entrants in power supply should share the State’s responsibilities

STATE OF PLAY

Shridhar Prabhu

Recently, in Karnataka, Tata Power Company Limited (TPCL) sought distribution licences across areas presently served by State-owned Electricity Supply Companies (ESCOs). These applications have come as the Union government is again considering competition in distributing electricity licences. Therefore, what Karnataka is deliberating on is not just a routine licensing request; it is deciding what kind of power market other States may later be asked to emulate.

The promise is attractive. Consumers want reliable supply and responsive service. Moreover, it has precedents – Mumbai has overlapping licensees; Delhi and Odisha use distinct distribution companies with State participation; and Ajmer follows a franchise model. But these precedents also teach caution. Competition for a market, where an operator assumes a defined territory, is different from competition within a market where suppliers seek consumers in an area which is already being serviced. Karnataka appears to be testing the latter.

Electricity is not ordinary retail. Urban households, commercial establishments and industries are easier and more profitable to serve. In contrast, rural supply, irrigation pumps and dispersed connections cost more. As State utilities cannot simply walk away from remote or commercially unattractive consumers, if an entrant gains access to remunerative urban pockets while inherited obligations stay with the State, reform may privatise revenue while socialising cost.



This makes geography important. Public descriptions of the TPCL’s applications refer to clusters of adjoining districts. A closer reading, however, appears to indicate a narrower footprint centred on city and town municipal areas. Karnataka’s licensing regulations require maps of the proposed supply area and a list of the local authorities concerned. These are not just clerical attachments; without accessible maps and an exact territorial description, consumers cannot know whether they are affected. The chosen geography must be explained before the process advances.

Questions of cost

The harder question is financial. State utilities use contributions from higher-paying consumers to support subsidised categories. They also carry long-term power-purchase commitments, including fixed charges that do not vanish when demand migrates. How will cross-subsidy surcharge and additional surcharge operate if TPCL supplies to consumers which already have ESCOM coverage?

The applications reportedly invoke a Supreme Court ruling which states that an incumbent network must facilitate wheeling for a parallel licensee on payment of wheeling charges and surcharge. However, that proposition cannot simply be trans-

planted into Karnataka without a carefully designed framework. Section 42 of the Electricity Act addresses open access, protection of existing cross-subsidy and recovery of stranded fixed costs. Karnataka has not determined a clear inter-licensee surcharge mechanism for this arrangement. The regulator must decide who pays, to whom, on what basis, and whether consumers using Tata Power’s future wires stand differently from those using ESCOM infrastructure. Otherwise, attractive consumers may migrate before the costs left behind are allocated. There is danger at both ends. If no surcharge is recovered, remaining ESCOM consumers absorb the deficit. If an ill-designed surcharge is added despite cross-subsidy already being embedded in Tata Power’s regulated retail tariff, migrating consumers may pay twice. Competition requires a principled method, not an improvised levy determined after public scrutiny.

Network design presents another choice. Competition should not produce parallel forests of poles, cables and substations. Nor should a new entrant rely indefinitely on public infrastructure without transparent charges and maintenance duties. India needs a neutral framework for shared networks.

None of this is an argument against private participation. However, consumer choice cannot be built on unclear maps, selective geography, duplicated networks or unresolved surcharges. The real question is not whether competition should enter electricity distribution. It is whether competition will carry the same obligations as the public system it seeks to disrupt.

The writer is an advocate focusing on consumer rights.

Fiscal prudence is the need of the hour for T.N.’s power utilities

The approach of successive governments to not hike user or service provider charges regularly has led to power sector entities accumulating debt

DATA POINT

T. Ramakrishnan

The grim financial health of the Tamil Nadu government has been accentuated by the plight of State Public Sector Undertakings (SPSUs). The recently released White Paper on public finances of Tamil Nadu has highlighted the deteriorating financial situation of the SPSUs (there are 78 SPSUs with about 2.55 lakh employees).

Describing the aggregate financial trajectory of the SPSUs as one of “deepening losses,” the White Paper provisionally puts the accumulated debt of select major undertakings at ₹3.18 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026 (**Chart 1**). The reasons for the SPSUs’ poor financial performance are not far to seek. Fundamentally, the enterprises recover only a small portion of their operational costs. It is not because of their inability to recover costs but because of the approach of successive governments, which did not hike user or service provider charges at regular intervals as and when the situation demanded. Consequently, the SPSUs are left with no surplus for investments in new capital assets or for the proper maintenance of existing assets, besides a persistent increase in their consolidated debt and accumulated losses (**Chart 2**).

Before dwelling upon this further, it is worthwhile to highlight how the power sector SPSUs have been reorganised in the past 16 years. The Tamil Nadu Electricity Board (TNEB) – which existed as a vertically integrated power utility between 1957 and 2010 – was reduced to a shell firm with the formation of two companies: Tamil Nadu Generation and Distribution Corporation Limited (TANGEDCO) and Tamil Nadu Transmission Corporation Limited.

In 2024, TANGEDCO ceased to exist after it was split into three new entities. The Tamil Nadu Pow-

er Generation Corporation Limited (TNPGL) and the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDC) were created to handle generation and distribution respectively. TANGEDCO’s renewable energy operations and the Tamil Nadu Energy Development Agency were clubbed to set up the Tamil Nadu Green Energy Corporation Limited (TNGECL).

The policy of free electricity, which was initially offered to farmers regardless of the size of their landholdings and huts, and subsequently extended to a host of other types of consumers, has substantially eroded the fiscal autonomy of the TNPDC (previously the TNEB or TANGEDCO), rendering it perpetually dependent on the financial assistance of the State government, which is already struggling to meet its commitments.

Moreover, in the last 10-odd years, only twice did the end domestic consumer witness a tariff increase, once with a “suo motu” tariff order in 2014 by the Tamil Nadu Electricity Regulatory Commission (TNERC) and via another order in 2022.

The number of domestic consumers alone went up by about 70 lakh in these years. Costly power purchases and materials procurement have contributed in no small measure to the stress on the DISCOM’s finances. The power tariffs were increased in 2024 and 2025, but consumers were spared as the government decided to absorb the increase through tariff subsidies.

Chart 3 shows the gap between the Average Cost of Supply (ACS) and the Average Revenue Realised (ARR) narrowing. While the tariff hike in 2022-23 helped to an extent, what has led to a positive change in the DISCOM’s finances is the financial support given by the State government, after taking a bailout package in 2020-21 from the Union government (**Chart 4**).

These numbers underscore that, hereafter, fiscal prudence should become the norm for the TNPDC and its sister companies.

Firmly in the red

The data for the charts were sourced from the White Paper on public finances of Tamil Nadu, released on June 16, 2026



Chart 1: Outstanding debt of Tamil Nadu government’s select public sector undertakings as on March 31, 2026. Their total accumulated debt stood at ₹3.18 lakh crore

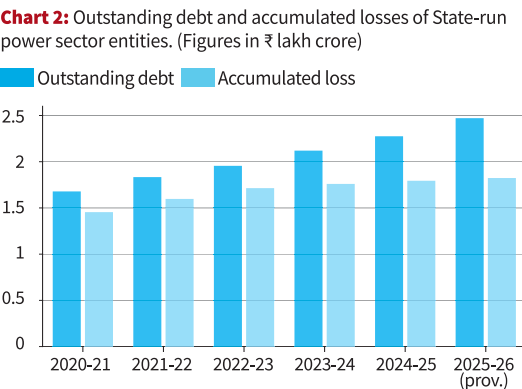
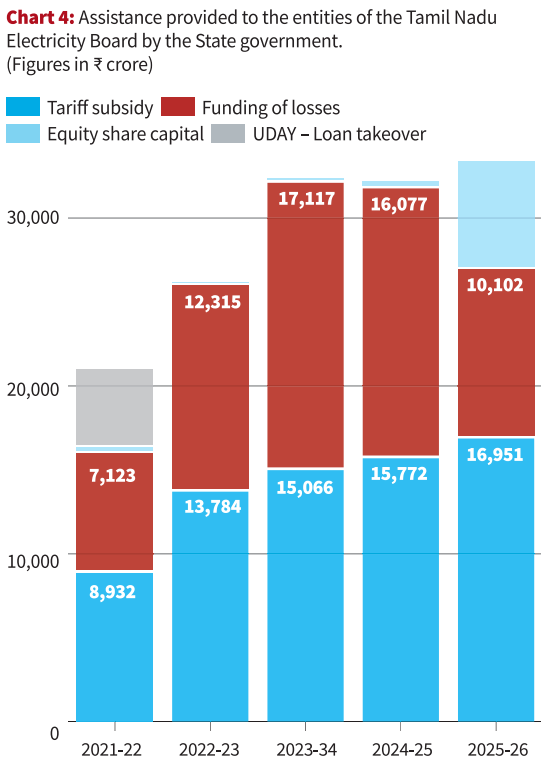


Chart 3: The gap between the Average Cost of Supply (ACS) and the Average Revenue Realised (ARR) has narrowed since 2023-24

Year	Power sold (MU)	ARR (₹ per unit)	ACS (₹ per unit)	Revenue gap (₹ per unit)	Revenue gap (excluding loss funding) (₹ per unit)
2021-22	82,076	7.65	9.23	-1.58	-2.4
2022-23	87,916	9.37	10.61	-1.24	-2.68
2023-24	92,735	10.66	11.14	-0.48	-2.32
2024-25	96,803	10.37	10.42	-0.05	-1.7
2025-26 (RE/Prov.)	99,885	10.41	10.37	0.04	-1.6

MU - Million units, RE/Prov. - Revised Estimate/Provisional



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO JUNE 24, 1976

Indo-Pak accord on Amritsar-Lahore Express Train Link

New Delhi, June 23: An express train will start running between Amritsar and Lahore when rail traffic between India and Pakistan is resumed. An agreement to this effect was reached between the railway experts of the two countries to-day when talks began here on the restoration of the rail links that had snapped in 1965.

The timings of the proposed express train are under discussion, keeping in view the connections to long distance mail and express trains at Amritsar and Lahore.

The expert teams of India and Pakistan, which are now discussing the modalities of resumption of rail traffic, will divide themselves into two groups.

The first group will go into the mechanical aspects of carriage and wagon fleets, loco arrangements etc. while the second group will sort out details about freight rating and compensation claims. The two groups will be formed after discussing the operational and mechanical issues connected with the expected passenger and goods traffic between the two countries consequent on resumption of the rail link. These discussions will be held by the two delegations in full strength.

During the talks, the experts will discuss the basic principles for movement of passenger and goods traffic.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO JUNE 24, 1926

Foreign advertiser reprimanded

London, June 22: Widely published reports of the tyreburst which recently occurred to the Prince of Wales when motoring at Thanet has had a sequel in the appearance of a semi-official reproof of an unnamed foreign advertising agency which states that the burst was not due to any defect in the tyre.

“The Prince uses British tyres and does not intend changing them for foreign ones. The attempt to exploit foreign tyres on account of the mishap is strongly resented by those responsible for the safety of His Royal Highness.”

From Page One

Govt. tightens norms for foreign contributions

Some categories specifically exclude political activities. For instance, the “educational” purpose lists 22 activities but adds the caveat that “awareness programmes on constitutional rights, fundamental duties, and civic responsibilities” must be “strictly non-political in nature.”

There are 16 permitted categories of religious activities, including “conduct of religious education, moral instruction, satsangs, discourses, and meditation retreats (excluding proselytisation)”, and “burial/cremation ground development and maintenance.” There are 19 activities listed under “economic” purpose, and 30 items under the “social” category.

The Ministry notified another order which specifies fines for FCRA violations such as excess administrative spending, speculative investments, misuse of funds, unauthorised receipt/use of foreign contributions, and using funds for unapproved purposes or in unapproved States or Union Territories. Any use of funds for purposes other than those for which they were received can attract a penalty of up to 30% of the amount misused or ₹1 lakh, whichever is higher. Similarly, using foreign funds for purposes or in areas not covered under the NGO’s approval or registration also invites a fine of 30% of the amount or ₹1 lakh, whichever is higher.

IMO plans to evacuate ships in Persian Gulf

The letter says that the Sultanate of Oman has worked with the IMO to provide all vessels with the option of a temporary maritime corridor as per listed coordinates. To reduce risks and ensure safe navigation, the IMO has developed a phased approach based on groups of vessels.

The letter says that the traditional traffic separation scheme is unsafe in a reference to mines, and two routes, one south and another north of it, shall be used for transit. Vessels will be contacted individually and advised of their allocated transit day by the parties coordinated by the IMO.

These two routes can handle 20-30 ships a day while the traditional route at the centre of the strait used to see some 130 ships transiting every day before the war. Hundreds of ships are still stranded west of the Strait of Hormuz.

There will be a designated waiting area within international waters where ships will go. From there, the vessels will contact “the relevant coastal state”, in a reference to Iran for the northern route. The letter adds: “Each shipowner and master remains responsible for conducting an independent risk assessment prior to voyage.” The Automatic Identification System of the vessel shall stay on, the letter adds.

The letter gives the coordinates of the Omani route that ships should take.

Wang seeks resumption of dialogue mechanism

“China and India have nearly 50 government-to-government dialogue mechanisms; unfortunately, most of them remain stalled,” Ambassador Xu had said speaking at *The Hindu* Huddle in Bengaluru.

Mr. Doval had, in Monday’s meeting on the sidelines of the BRICS NSAs meeting in New Delhi, underlined that stable, predictable and constructive bilateral relations contribute to building trust and better understanding between the two sides.

Yet the normalisation process has been in fits and starts with even simpler measures, such as the resumption of direct flights, taking many months of long-winding negotiations. Other dialogue mechanisms are yet to resume, even as both sides are finalising arrangements for Mr. Doval to visit Beijing for the next round of talks with Mr. Wang under the Special Representatives mechanism.

A lengthier Chinese readout of the talks released early on Tuesday said Mr. Wang, who is also Director of the Office of the Central Foreign Affairs Commission, stated in Monday’s talks that “India is an important neighbour of China.”

“Under the joint guidance of President Xi Jinping and Prime Minister Narendra Modi, China-India relations have gradually emerged from their low point and returned to a track of recovery and improvement. The leaders of both countries agree that China and India are partners, not rivals, which forms the most important strategic consensus between the two sides and provides crucial momentum and strategic assurance for the healthy and stable development of China-India relations,” the statement said.

“These achievements did not come easily and deserve to be cherished all the more,” he said. “Both sides need to take practical actions to implement the important consensus of the two countries’ leaders, assist each other’s development and revitalisation through cooperation, and push the Global South to accelerate its modernisation process. The two sides should respect each other’s core interests, properly handle sensitive issues, place the China-India boundary issue in its appropriate position, and prevent it from affecting the overall situation of bilateral relations.”

The Chinese statement quoted Mr. Doval as saying Mr. Modi and Mr. Xi, through their meetings in Kazan in October 2024 and Tianjin in August 2025, had “pointed the way forward for the development of bilateral relations through their meetings in Kazan and Tianjin”.

Farmers’ group flags ration risk for lakhs in West Bengal

Supreme Court says petitioners must ideally move Calcutta HC; plea claims that the outcome of SIR has been linked to food security schemes in the State and could impact welfare benefits

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday said petitioners must ideally move the Calcutta High Court with a plea that a West Bengal government order on June 4 effectively deprived lakhs who were purged from the voters’ list after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) access to subsidised ration and nutrition.

Appearing before a Bench headed by Justice B.V. Nagarathna, the Paschim Banga Khet Majoor Samity, an independent trade union of agricultural labourers, marginal farmers and sharecroppers, submitted that the outcome of the SIR has been linked to the working of the Public Distribution System (PDS) and Anna-purna Yojana.

The PDS is a welfare mechanism intended to secure access to essential food grains for economically vulnerable households. The scheme operates within the framework of the National Food Security Act of 2013. It is designed to ensure basic sus-



Food security benefits for the economically vulnerable must not be dependent on exercises such as the SIR, the petition said. PTI

tenance to families facing economic hardships. The Annapurna Yojana is a welfare scheme intended to provide financial assistance to economically vulnerable women.

The farmers’ group, represented by advocate Prasanna S., argued that food security benefits for the economically vulnerable must not be dependent on unrelated considerations like SIR.

‘Pattern in other States’ In an oral mentioning before the Bench, which included Justice Joymalya Bagchi, counsel submitted from the petition that the June 4 order reflected an

“emerging pattern” among other States, indicating similar exclusionary linkages between SIR outcomes and welfare schemes.

The petitioner contended that the June 4 order has directed authorities to identify, scrutinise and delete beneficiaries on the basis of classifications generated during the SIR, effectively introducing into the food security framework considerations entirely foreign to the purposes of the National Food Security Act, 2013.

Counsel submitted that the June 4 order effectively treats electoral status, inclusion in electoral rolls

and criteria generated during electoral verification exercises as valid determinants of entitlement to food security benefits.

Nevertheless, the impugned order effectively treats such classifications as indicators of eligibility. The petitioners have argued that a linkage between SIR and food security schemes may lead to inactivation of the ration cards of 35 lakh and 60 lakh people in the State.

Counsel submitted that the deletion of names from the PDS and Annapurna Scheme only on the basis of the SIR would result in no opportunity of being heard for the aggrieved persons. Such a conduct on the part of the State militates against its welfare character under the Constitution.

The Bench remarked that a primary determination has to be made if the cause of action in the petition really emanated from the SIR exercise, as canvassed by the petitioner, or was due to other policy reasons. The apex court urged the petitioner to first approach the High Court.

Centre is trying to dilute its promise, say Ladakh groups

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

Ladakh’s Kargil and Leh districts on Tuesday observed a shutdown over the failure of the Centre to release the minutes of a meeting held on May 22, which apparently agreed to a new set of democratic and constitutional guarantees for the region.

Most markets and businesses in Leh and Kargil, the two main towns in Ladakh, witnessed a shutdown in response to a call by the Ladakh Buddhist Association (LBA) and the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA), among the main civil society groups that engaged the Centre in a dialogue over long-pending demands of Statehood, and inclusion in the Sixth Schedule.

“All important points related to constitutional safeguards and an elected legislative body for Ladakh were omitted from the official meeting record. We refused to endorse the minutes after noticing the omission of key provisions, including safeguards under Article 371 and powers for a proposed elected body in the Union Territory. The Centre is making an attempt to dilute the com-

Markets in Kargil and Leh districts observe a shutdown after a call by civil society bodies

mitments,” the LBA’s president Tsering Dorje Lakrook, who addressed a gathering at the Polo Ground in Leh, said.

Mr. Lakrook also criticised proposals promoting large-scale investments and luxury tourism. The new excise policy had been introduced “without adequate consultation”, he said.

Sajjad Kargili, a senior member of the KDA, who attended the May 22 talks with the Centre, said the bandh “reflects the growing demand of the people of Ladakh for democratic rights, constitutional safeguards, protection of land and resources, and greater participation in decisions that directly impact their future”.

According to the Leh Apex Body and the Kargil Democratic Alliance, the Centre on May 22 offered constitutional safeguards under Article 371, instead of the Sixth Schedule, and a legislative body with a Chief Minister for Ladakh.

BRICS can play a key role in tackling terrorism: PM

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

India’s leadership of the BRICS grouping will help in enhancing priorities of the Global South, said Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday.

Meeting the National Security Advisers of the BRICS member-countries here, Mr. Modi said the grouping can play a vital role in dealing with terrorism, cyber security, and other common challenges.

“In a challenging global landscape, BRICS has a vital role in deepening security cooperation and addressing shared challenges, from terrorism and cyber security to emerging technologies. India’s chairmanship will seek to advance practical cooperation, support the priorities of the Global South, and contribute to a safer and more secure and inclusive world,” said Mr. Modi while meeting the NSAs of the BRICS member-states.

The member-states held a two-day meeting here from June 22 where the delegates discussed energy and food security, supply chain disruption, emerging technologies that are used by terrorist networks, cyber security, and climate-induced instability.

The delegations expressed their “full support” to India’s BRICS chairship in 2026 under the theme: ‘Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability’, said the MEA in a statement.

Iran’s complaint The meeting also witnessed some tense moments when the delegates of the UAE and Iran clashed over the war in the Gulf with Ghadiri Nezami-pour, leader of the Iranian delegation.

“Attacks were launched from bases located on the territory of the United Arab Emirates, Mr. Nezami-pour said.

President presents second set of Padma awards

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Tennis legend Vijay Amritraj, actors Mammootty and Satish Shah, cricketer Rohit Sharma, and playback singer Alka Yagnik were among the eminent personalities who received the Padma awards from President Droupadi Murmu on Tuesday.

The Padma awards, one of the highest civilian awards of the country, are conferred in three categories: the Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan, and the Padma Shri.

In the second civil investiture ceremony at the Ganatantra Mandap of the Rashtrapati Bhavan, the President presented the Padma Vibhushan to former Supreme Court judge K. T. Thomas for public affairs and to eminent Malayalam



President Droupadi Murmu confers the Padma Vibhushan on former Supreme Court judge K.T. Thomas during the second civil investiture ceremony in New Delhi on Tuesday. Tennis legend Vijay Amritraj and playback singer Alka Yagnik received the Padma Bhushan. PTI, ANI

journalist P. Narayanan for contribution to literature and education.

Alka Yagnik, Mammootty, American oncologist Dattatreya Nari, Vijay Amritraj, industrialist S.K.M. Maelanandhan, and social worker and educationist Vellappally Natesan received the Padma Bhushan from the Presi-

dent during the ceremony. Rupri Soren, wife of Jharkhand Mukti Morcha founder Shibu Soren, received the Padma Bhushan on behalf of the late leader.

Padma Shri The President conferred the Padma Shri on cricketer Rohit Sharma, who led India to victory in the last



T-20 World Cup, and on hockey player Savita Punia. Actor R. Madhavan, aerospace scientist Chandramouli Gaddamanugu, who led the Akash missile system from development to deployment during Operation Sindoor, and noted writer Asok Kumar Halder were among those who received the Padma Shri.

Vladimir Mestvirishvili, the Georgian coach who mentored Indian Olympic medalists such as Sushil Kumar, Yogeshwar Dutt, and Ravi Dahiya, was awarded the Padma Shri posthumously.

The President also conferred the Padma Shri on actor Satish Shah posthumously.

SIT visits blaze site in Lucknow, meets injured in hospital

The Hindu Bureau
LUCKNOW

The two-member Special Investigation Team (SIT) on Tuesday visited the Lucknow fire incident site and later met the injured victims admitted to King George’s Medical University (KGMU). The SIT gathered information regarding the incident. A team from the Uttar Pradesh Forensic Science Laboratory (FSL) also collected crucial evidence from the site.

At least 15 people, mostly students, were killed and five were injured in the fire that engulfed the three-storey commercial building housing a graphics animation centre, a pet shop, and a library in Aliganj area of the city on Monday. SIT members Amrit Abhijat, Additional Chief Secretary, Tourism and Culture Department, and Praveen Kumar, ADG, Lucknow Zone, reached the site in

Congress blames Uttar Pradesh govt. over administrative lapses and ‘sheer negligence’

the morning. They conducted a detailed inspection of the entire building for over an hour.

The final report will be prepared after completing all stages of the inquiry, Mr. Abhijat said.

Uttar Pradesh Congress unit president Ajay Rai alleged that the State government bears full responsibility for this incident. “The Lucknow fire incident is the result of sheer negligence on the part of the government and administration. A demolition order had already been issued against the building. The electricity load far exceeded the capacity of the electricity connection provided by the department.”

Japanese PM to visit Delhi; Assam plan cancelled

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi will not visit Guwahati from July 1-3, as was planned earlier. She will hold her interactions in Delhi because of the “tight” schedule, *The Hindu* has learnt. The Guwahati part of her visit was earlier planned as the centrepiece of the tour, as Japan reportedly wanted to highlight the importance of India’s northeast in Japan’s plans for South and Southeast Asia and the Indo-Pacific initiative.

“Given PM Takaichi’s domestic commitments, including an ongoing Japanese Parliament, the window between her proposed arrival in India and her departure is quite tight,” a source told *The Hindu*.

The meetings would now be held in New Delhi as Ms. Takaichi makes her first official visit to India.

SC stays premature release of convict in Bowbazar blast case

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday stayed a Delhi High Court decision to prematurely release 78-year-old Rashid Khan serving a life sentence for the 1993 Bowbazar blast case that left 69 people dead in Kolkata.

A Bench of Justices P.K. Mishra and Sanjeev Sachdeva remarked that the actions of Mr. Khan amount-

ed to “almost a terrorist activity” and he had played the “role of a mastermind”.

The defence counsel, who accepted the apex court notice on the petition filed by the West Bengal government, argued that Khan’s health was bad. He had been imprisoned for about 33 years, and his conduct had been excellent throughout. The case was kept for further hearing in early July.



APPEAL
Krishna Prasanna is 13 years old suffering from "T Cell - Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia". He needs Chemotherapy and Radiation Therapy at Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai. The total expenditure is **Rs.8,00,000/-**. His father works as a labourer. The family is very poor and cannot afford this huge cost. Please support him for the treatment. Donations sent by Ch/D.D. favouring **Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai will be acknowledged.** The donations sent through Ch/D.D/NEFT Transfer & GOOGLE PAY (Canara Bank, Nungambakkam Branch, A/c No. 60182010063310, IFSC No: CNRB0016018) favouring **WOMEN'S WELFARE SYNDICATE** is exempted under 80G IT. All correspondence is done through **WWS, Regd Public Charitable Trust, Flat No. GF 1, Cordell Apartments, O.No.13, N.No. 29, Pycrofts Garden Lane, Chennai-600006. Ph: 044-42137401/ 31523781/ 7338978027. E-mail ID: womenswelfare Syndicate@gmail.com Website: www.womenswelfare Syndicate.org**

WWS

George Kurian resigns as Union Minister after RS tenure ends

Senior BJP leader from Kerala steps down as Minister of State as BJP did not renominate him in the recent election to the Upper House; he was the only Christian Minister in the NDA govt.; his resignation sets off talks about a Cabinet reshuffle

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI/ KOTTAYAM

George Kurian has resigned as the Union Minister of State for Minority Affairs following the completion of his Rajya Sabha tenure. President Droupadi Murmu accepted his resignation on Tuesday.

Mr. Kurian, a senior Bharatiya Janata Party leader from Kerala, held the additional charge of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry, and Dairying portfolios.

He retired from the Rajya Sabha on June 21 and the BJP leadership had decided not to renominate him to the Upper House in the recent election, thus necessitating his resignation from the Union Ministry.

A communique from the Rashtrapati Bhavan



Party work: BJP leader George Kurian is likely to return to active organisational responsibilities in his home State of Kerala. ANI

said Mr. Kurian's resignation was accepted under clause (2) of Article 75 of the Constitution with immediate effect.

Long association

Hailing from Kottayam district, Mr. Kurian was the sole Christian Minister in the National Democratic

Alliance (NDA) government and took charge on June 9, 2024.

Mr. Kurian had been associated with the BJP and the RSS since 1980, holding various positions including of party spokesperson and vice-president of the Kerala BJP unit. He had served as the Vice-Chairperson of

He has been associated with the BJP and the RSS since 1980, holding various positions

the National Commission for Minorities and as Officer on Special Duty in the office of former Union Minister of State for Railways O. Rajagopal. He had been elected to the Rajya Sabha from Madhya Pradesh.

Kurian thanks PM

His resignation set off speculation that a reshuffle of the Union Cabinet was in the offing. Minister of State for Railways Ravneet Singh Bittu's Rajya Sabha term also came to an end when Mr. Kurian's did, but no resignation has been forthcoming from him till the time of writing.

In a Facebook post after

his resignation was accepted, Mr. Kurian said that becoming a Union Minister was not something that he had imagined and thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi for the opportunity.

Sharing a photograph of himself with Mr. Modi, he said he had personally thanked the Prime Minister when they met on June 22, and he had submitted his resignation.

"I had never imagined, not even in my dreams, that I would become a Union Minister. It was only because Narendra Modi became Prime Minister that I was given the opportunity to serve as a Union Minister," he wrote.

Sources in the BJP said Mr. Kurian is likely to return to active organisational responsibilities and has conveyed to the party leadership that he is interested in working in Kerala.

Congress urges Centre not to rush into signing a trade agreement with the U.S.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Tuesday urged the Union government not to be "bambooed" into signing a trade agreement with the United States, arguing that the proposed deal in its current form was tilted against India's interests.

In a post on X, Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said Prime Minister Narendra Modi should stop "appeasing" U.S. President Donald Trump and resist the pressure to conclude an agreement during the visit of U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer to New Delhi. The deal could adversely affect farmers and domestic industry, he said.

Mr. Ramesh referred to the India-U.S. joint statement issued on February 6, in which the U.S. had proposed reduction of tariffs on Indian exports



There is absolutely no need for India to be bamboozled into signing any trade pact which, as it stands now, is heavily against India's interests

JAIRAM RAMESH
Congress leader

while India was expected to substantially lower tariffs on American agricultural and industrial products and increase purchases from the U.S.

He said that the understanding had been undermined by a subsequent ruling of the U.S. Supreme Court which found President Trump's reciprocal tariff policy to be illegal.

Mr. Ramesh stated that the tariff concessions promised by the U.S. effectively became uncertain after the court ruling, and Washington later imposed a temporary 10% tariff on

imports from trading partners, including India.

Stating that India was among the countries being investigated by the U.S. for alleged unfair trade practices, Mr. Ramesh alleged that Washington was using the probe to pressure New Delhi into formalising the proposed agreement.

"Such an agreement is not a deal but a steal by the U.S.," he said. "There is absolutely no need for India to be bamboozled into signing any trade agreement which, as it stands now, is heavily against India's interests," he said.

SIT submits initial report in Ram Temple donation case

The Hindu Bureau
LUCKNOW

The Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the alleged irregularities in donations at the Ayodhya Ram Temple submitted its preliminary report to the Uttar Pradesh government on Tuesday.

Vijay Vishwas Pant, Commissioner of the Lucknow Division and a key member of the SIT, along with the other two members of the team, submitted the preliminary report to Sanjay Prasad, Additional Chief Secretary (Home).

The State government had constituted the SIT at the request of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust amid allegations of corruption and missing donation. The SIT is examining all aspects related to the matter and is carrying out a comprehensive investigation.

The Congress demanded the report to be made public and pushed for a White Paper on the issue with all records and bank statements.

Congress seeks high-level probe into 'Ujjain land scam' by family of M.P. CM

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

The Congress on Tuesday demanded a high-level investigation by a committee led by a Supreme Court judge into the alleged land scam by Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav's family members after a report claimed that they purchased property where infrastructure projects were later announced.

A report by an English daily has claimed, citing government land records, that Mr. Yadav's wife, son, and daughter-in-law, as well as members of his extended family, had purchased 168 acres of land through 137 plots in and around Ujjain from December 2023, when he replaced Shivraj Singh Chouhan as the Chief Minister, to December 2025.

The purchases were either made by them directly or through four real estate companies owned by them. The report claimed that most of these



Umang Singh

purchases were made in areas where government road projects or the Ujjain Master Plan, 2035 proposes turning agricultural land into residential or commercial properties.

'Planned manner'

Addressing a press conference here, the Leader of the Opposition in the Legislative Assembly, Umang Singh, said the land prices were increased in a "well planned manner" by bringing projects there, and land was purchased in those areas before announcing the projects.

"Certainly, the Chief Minister will say that 'everything happened as per rules and law, and that we file the income tax'. But our demand is that a Supreme Court judge should investigate this by forming a committee," Mr. Singh said, adding that the probe would reveal the people linked to the matter and who got benefited.

"We know that the Chief Minister will not get this probed by an SIT or give answers. This is why we are demanding a probe by a Supreme Court judge-led committee," he said.

Congress national general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal hit out at Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the BJP asking why Central agencies like the Enforcement Directorate or the CBI had not probed Mr. Yadav yet.

"Is a 253-acre mega land scam not grounds enough to chase him and punish him for his crimes?" he said, targeting the ruling party over alleged misuse of Central agencies.

Govt. asks Dipke to be present for ban hearing

Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology has asked Cockroach Janta Party founder Abhijeet Dipke to be physically present for a hearing on the Centre's blocking of the CJP account on X, a CJP

source told *The Hindu*.

The summoning comes even as Mr. Dipke has refused to leave Jantar Mantar, where he has been leading a protest calling for Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation since Saturday.

Mr. Dipke has been called to be present at Elec-

tronics Niketan, the MeitY headquarters, on Wednesday afternoon.

The CJP source termed this a "fresh escalation", referring to the Delhi Police's actions in clearing out the designated protest site near Jantar Mantar. Mr. Dipke has complained of long interruptions to water

and food access to the site, as well as disruptions to running water at the wash rooms.

The hearing is set to take place before an Inter-Ministerial Committee, and is pursuant to an administrative appeal the CJP founder filed against the blocking.

KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE
O/o the Executive Engineer, Generation Division, Poringalkuthu, Thrissur.
E-Tender ID No.2026_KSEB_856577_1:
PAC: Rs. Rs.1,87,84,364/- Last Date: 20.07.2026, 05.00 pm
O/o the Chief Engineer, (REES&PED), Vyduthi Bhavanam, Thiruvananthapuram
Tender ID No.KSEB/CE/REES/INNOV/VECELL/PMEDRIVE/01/2026-27- dtd 19/06/2026
PAC: Rs.128 Crores - Last Date:18.07.2026, 05.00 pm
Documents available in site: <https://www.mstcecommerce.com/eprocn/>
Visit www.etenders.kerala.gov.in and www.kseb.in
Ref : PR/MC1/E620 - E-tender/2026

Office of the Additional Chief Engineer (Project) PHED Bharatpur
E-mail- aceproj.bha.phed@rajasthan.gov.in, aceprojbpr@gmail.com
Notice Inviting Bid No.04/2024-25 & 05/2024-25, Corrigendum No.14
Due to unavoidable circumstances bid submission date of this office NIT no. 04/2024-25 & 05/2024-25 has extended and last date of submission has been made as date 17.09.2026. Other terms and conditions will remain as per Tender Documents.
NIT 04/2025-25: UBN No.: PHE2425WLOB07192
NIB Code: PHE2425A3390
NIT 05/2025-25: UBN No.: PHE2425WLOB07193
NIB Code: PHE2425A3391
(Surendra Sharma)
Addl. Chief Engineer (P)
PHED Bharatpur, Rajasthan
DIPRC/10824/2026 Rajkaj Ref No.:22845182

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER (PROJECT) PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT, BHARATPUR
Chambal Head Works Mallah Road, Bharatpur (321001)
E-mail- aceproj.bha.phed@rajasthan.gov.in
Notice Inviting Bid No. 03/2024-25 Corrigendum No.15
Due to unavoidable circumstances bid submission date of this office NIT no. 03/2024-25 (Kalliter Water Supply Project) has extended and last date of submission has been made as date 17.09.2026. Other terms and conditions as per Tender Documents.
UBN No.: PHE2425WLOB07189 (Surendra Sharma)
NIB Code: PHE2425A3388 Addl. Chief Engineer (P)
DIPRC/10821/2026 Rajkaj Ref No. 22844237 PHED Bharatpur, Rajasthan

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER (PROJECT) PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT, BHARATPUR
Chambal Head Works Mallah Road, Bharatpur (321001)
E-mail- aceproj.bha.phed@rajasthan.gov.in
Notice Inviting Bid No.07, 08 & 09/2024-25 Corrigendum No.11
Due to unavoidable circumstances bid submission date of this office NIT no. 07/2024-25, 08-2024-25 & 09/2024-25 has extended and last date of submission has been made as date 17.09.2026. Other terms and conditions will remain as per Tender Document.
UBN No.: NIT 07/2024-25: PHE2425WLOB07198 (NIB Code: PHE2425A3393)
NIT 08/2024-25: PHE2425WLOB07199 (NIB Code: PHE2425A3394)
NIT 09/2024-25: PHE2425WLOB07201 (NIB Code: PHE2425A3395)
(Surendra Sharma)
Addl. Chief Engineer (P)
PHED Bharatpur, Rajasthan
DIPRC/10822/2026 Rajkaj Ref No.:22844389

ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES
Mangalagiri, Guntur District, Andhra Pradesh -522503
[Advt No. AIIMS/MG/Committee/Ph.D/2026 dtd. 22-06-2026]
Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) Degree
Admission Notice for the Session July-2026
AIIMS Mangalagiri invites applications for admission into **Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) Degree** for the session July-2026.
The candidates who wish to apply submit the duly filled and signed application form along with the required documents to pa.deana@aiimsmangalagiri.edu.in.
Important Dates:
• Application Starting Date: 22.06.2026
• Application Closing Date: 19.07.2026
• Entrance Examination: 23.07.2026 (11:00 AM - 12:30 PM)
For the Prospectus, Detailed Admission Notice, Application Form, and other details, please visit www.aiimsmangalagiri.edu.in/admissioncategory/ph-d-admission/
Candidates are advised to visit the website regularly for Updates, Corrigendum, and Addendum.
Sd/-, Dean (Academic), AIIMS, Mangalagiri

MINISTRY OF DEFENCE, GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
INS ZAMORIN, EZHIMALA
TENDER NOTICE
1. Online Bids are invited (Two Bid System basis) through DPP Portal (www.defproc.gov.gov.in) for outsourcing of service for hiring of manpower for Unit Run Canteen at INS Zamorin, Ezhimala for a period of 02 years (Twenty four months).
2. **Schedule of Manpower Requirement.** Accountant (01 No.), Office Clerks/ Billing Clerks (10 Nos) and Helpers (03 Nos).
3. Online Bids should be submitted through Defence Public Procurement (DPP) portal www.defproc.gov.in only. Tender ID : 2026_NAVY_773151_1. Manual Bids will not be considered.
4. Last date and time for submission of Online Bids - 01 Jul 26 at 1000 hrs.
(Commanding Officer)
INS Zamorin

CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF RAJASTHAN
nirf
APPOINTMENT OF COACHES (ON CONTRACT BASIS)
Applications are invited for conducting Diploma/Certificate courses in Sports Coaching programme in following sports disciplines:
• BOXING • BADMINTON • TABLE TENNIS • ATHLETICS
• WUSHU • CRICKET • HOCKEY • FOOTBALL
• KABADDI • VOLLEYBALL • BASKETBALL
For more details, visit: www.curaj.ac.in
Registrar

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER (PROJECT) PHED BHARATPUR
Email- aceproj.bha.phed@rajasthan.gov.in, aceprojbpr@gmail.com
Notice Inviting Bid No. 06/2024-25 Corrigendum No.15
Due to unavoidable circumstances bid submission date of this office NIT no. 06/2024-25 has extended and last date of submission has been made as date 17.09.2026. Other terms and conditions will remain as per Tender Documents.
UBN No.: PHE2425WLOB07194
NIB Code: PHE2425A3392 (Surendra Sharma)
Addl. Chief Engineer (P)
PHED Bharatpur, Rajasthan
DIPRC/10827/2026 Rajkaj Ref No. 22845852

भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, भरतपुर
क्रमांक - लेखा/न.वि.प्रा./2026-27/7052 - 65 दिनांक :- 12/06/2026
ऑनलाइन निविदा सूचना सं. 21/2026-27
राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से भरतपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, में उपयुक्त श्रेणी एवं विभिन्न विभागों में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्वायरेमेंट प्रक्रिया से कुल 01 कार्यों हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।
उक्त कार्यों का विस्तृत विवरण, निविदा शर्तें, अनुमानित लागत राशि, निविदा बेचने, प्राप्त करने एवं खोलने की दिनांक आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेबसाईट <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> portal पर देखा जा सकता है।
निविदा से संबंधित किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> portal का अवलोकन करें।
UBN विवरण : WAQ2627WSOB00063
न्या.संवा.क/री.26/5457 अधिरात्री अतिरिक्ता

Bangalore Electricity Supply Company Limited
(Wholly owned Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
(CIN: U04010KA2002SGC030438)
NOTIFICATION INVITING TENDER (Through KPP Portal)
No: BESCOM/CGM(Proj)/DGM-1/AGM-1/BC-14/26-27/CYS-109
BESCOM Re-invites the tender for Providing Electrical infrastructure to the regularized IP sets by extending 11 KV lines, Erection of 25 KVA Star 1 (4 Star) rated Distribution Transformers and Extension of LT line on Partial Turnkey basis (25 KVA Distribution Transformer will be supplied by BESCOM) in Nittur sub-division of Tumakuru Division under PERCENTAGE QUOTING BASIS. Details are as below.
Tender Enquiry No: **BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT898/CALL-2**
Availability of Bid documents: **25.06.2026 onwards**. Last date for submission of bid Queries: **30.06.2026 before 17:00 Hrs.** Pre-Bid meeting: **01.07.2026 at 11:00 Hrs. Venue of Pre-Bid Meeting:** O/o Chief General Manager, Projects, 403, Corporate Office, BESCOM, K. R Circle, Bengaluru-560 001. Last date & Time for bid submission: **06.07.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.** Opening of Technical Bids: **07.07.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.** The bid documents can be downloaded and necessary assistance can be obtained through the e-procurement portal from the website <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>
E-procurement Help Desk: Phone No: +91-8046010000 +91-8068948777 E-mail: support@eprochelpdesk.com Aspiring bidders needs to be registered on e-procurement portal. Bidders can take the assistance from the e-procurement during office working hours.
Sd/- Chief General Manager (Ele), Projects, BESCOM.
E mail: cgproject.bescom@gmail.com
For Electricity related complaints call: 1912 Download BESCOM Mithra Mobile APP

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Amid the ongoing rebellion in the party, the Trinamool Congress led by party chairperson and former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee has sent a fresh list of its office-bearers and national working committee members to the Election Commission. The rebel faction of Trinamool, which had appointed a new party chairperson on Monday, also submitted their list of office-bearers to the EC through the office of West Bengal Chief Electoral Officer on Tuesday.

According to the list of office-bearers submitted on Monday by Mamata loyalists, she remains the chairperson of the party while Subrata Bakshi is the vice-president and Abhishek Banerjee the national general secretary and the party's leader in the Lok



Trinamool Congress leaders Mamata Banerjee and Abhishek Banerjee at a press conference. FILE PHOTO

Sabha. The list also names Rajya Sabha member Derek O'Brien and Dola Sen as joint secretaries and Subhasish Chakraborty as treasurer. The national working committee includes Ms. Banerjee, Mr. Bakshi, Mr. Banerjee, Mr. O'Brien, Ms. Sen, and Mr. Chakraborty. Chandrima Bhattacharya has been listed as a member of the national working committee

and as West Bengal Trinamool president, while Sobhandeb Chattopadhyay has been listed as a member and leader of the Legislature Party.

A special session

The development comes a day after the rebel faction led by Ritabrata Banerjee held a special session in Kolkata and announced a parallel organisational

structure. Former Minister Aroop Roy was appointed the new chairperson of the party and MLAs from the Trinamool rebel camp – Mr. Ritabrata Banerjee, Sandipan Saha, and Jawed Khan – were named general secretaries.

Mr. Ritabrata Banerjee said following the national working committee meeting where the party chairperson was elected, it was necessary to inform the EC.

"The Election Commission must be apprised whenever such events take place. It was a routine process; we had already apprised them in Delhi, and today we came here to do the same," the Leader of the Opposition said.

Sources close to the Mamata camp said the party had issued showcase notice to the leaders of the rebel camp who have been appointed office-bearers.

Business

INBRIEF



Adani opens Mundra airport for flights to four cities

Adani Group has thrown open its captive airport at Mundra for scheduled commercial flight operations to four destinations which are being operated under the Regional Connectivity Scheme. Star Air owned by Kolhapur-based Sanjay Ghodawat Group started operating flights from the Mundra airport from Tuesday. The four destinations, which are now available for regular air connectivity with Mundra include Mumbai, Goa, Surat, and Hindon (Delhi NCR).

‘56 critical, strategic mineral blocks auctioned till date’

The Union Mines Ministry informed on Tuesday that it had auctioned 10 critical and strategic mineral blocks associated with the seventh tranche of auctions, implying that 56 of 88 mineral blocks had been cumulatively auctioned across all tranches till date. The seventh tranche, which commenced March 23 this year, offered 19 mineral blocks. The Ministry also informed it had completed the second tranche of exploration licence auctions.

Square Yards turns Unicorn with ₹900 crore funding

Real estate consultant Square Yards on Tuesday said it has raised ₹900 crore from investors to grow its business and refinance debt. Sources said the ₹900 crore (\$95 million) funding includes around one-third equity and two-thirds debt, at a valuation of more than \$1 billion, thereby helping the company achieve unicorn status. The company has also announced plans to launch its maiden public issue. PTI

RBI tweaks process to onboard MSMEs on TReDS platform

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) issued its final directions on Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) for MSMEs to simplify the system.

The banking regulator fixed a minimum net worth of ₹25 crore and certification by a statutory auditor to provide discounting services. Entities

providing the service have been given a deadline of March 31, 2028 to comply with networth norm.

TReDS is an online platform which aids small businesses auction invoices or trade receivables to banks and other financial institutions to unlock working capital. The move seeks to aid MSMEs receive customer payments as they might face issues in converting trade receivables to cash.

India needs to boost speed of doing business: CII chief

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI



R. Mukundan

India’s reforms process needs to move from solely concentrating on ease-of-doing business to addressing the speed of doing business, new president of the Confederation of Indian Industry R. Mukundan told *The Hindu* in an interview.

Further, at a time when government officials such as the Chief Economic Adviser had pulled up the private sector for not investing enough, Mr. Mukundan argued that such investments were in fact increasing and would become apparent soon.

“We need to reform even more,” said Mr. Mukundan, also MD and CEO of Tata Chemicals.

Mr. Mukundan added there are always some ‘friction points’ that delay processes and these need to be addressed.

Resilient MSMEs

He further said the West Asia crisis and the energy constraints it had created had taught Indian businesses to ensure India’s MSMEs continue to thrive.

Yet another area that needs further reforms is in infrastructure, he added.

El Nino: 111 districts in 12 States of ‘primary concern’

While 315 districts have been identified as potentially affected by weak monsoon, 111 among them, with irrigation coverage below 25%, have been categorised as high priority, says Chouhan

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan has held a high level meeting with State Agriculture Ministers and officials on the El Nino situation, that has led to a delay of the southwest monsoon. Talking to reporters after the meeting, Mr. Chouhan said the rainfall so far has been around 43% below normal.

The Centre has assessed that 315 districts are vulnerable and 111 districts in 12 States are of primary concern due to poor irrigation facilities. “We are preparing in advance. Not waiting for a crisis,” the Minister said, adding that each of the 315 districts would have a contingency plan to face the challenge.

Agriculture Ministers of States, senior officials, District Collectors of vulnerable regions, experts from the Indian Council of Agricultural Research and offi-



Parched pastures: Rainfall is likely to remain weak even during the week ending July 2 and this could directly affect Kharif crops. PTI

cials of the Union Agriculture Ministry and the Indian Meteorological Department attended the meeting. Citing IMD forecasts, he said rainfall was likely to remain weak even during the week ending July 2. “This could directly affect Kharif crops, particularly in rain-fed regions where agriculture is heavily dependent on monsoon rains,” he said.

“Around 315 districts have been identified as potentially affected by weak monsoon conditions. Of

these, 111 districts [20 of these districts are in Maharashtra] have been categorised as high priority, where irrigation coverage is below 25%. Another 76 districts fall under the medium-priority category with irrigation coverage between 25 and 50%, while 128 districts have been classified as low priority owing to relatively better irrigation facilities through dams and other sources,” the Minister told reporters.

The districts are located across M.P., Maharashtra,

Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Karnataka, Bihar, Jharkhand, Telangana, A.P. and Odisha. “Detailed discussions were held with Agriculture Ministers and District Collectors of these states,” he said, adding that the District Agriculture Contingency Plans, prepared by the ICAR, incorporated district-specific climatic conditions, cropping patterns, and water resources and prescribed measures such as suitable alternative crops under low rainfall conditions, crop diversification strategies, optimum use of available water resources and additional income opportunities to mitigate risks.

“Water conservation and harvesting works under MGNREGA and forthcoming rural development programmes such as VBGRAMG should receive priority so that employment generation and enhancement of water storage capacity can go hand in hand,” he said.

Global tech sell-off upsets Indian bourse

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Benchmark Nifty50 declined 1.16% from its previous session, closing at 23,824.1 points, as global investors were spooked by the South Korean market

regulator’s statement on investing in products with AI-driven stocks.

More than 2,000 of the nearly 3,399 stocks declined. All but three sectoral indices, including healthcare and pharma, declined, suggesting a

broad-based dip. On Monday, South Korea’s Financial Supervisory Service (FSS) Governor Lee Chanjin criticised the approval of single-stock leveraged ETFs. He opined the ETF product may be good only for brokerages. The hype

in the fundamentals of the AI rally led to profit booking, with KOSPI, the South Korean Stock Exchange, plunging 10% in one session. This led to a global sell-off of technology stocks with the panic spilling over into India as well.

IRDAI mulls panel to manage ₹800-cr. PEPF

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

IRDAI plans to set up a management panel to oversee the administration of the ₹800 crore Policyholders’ Education and Protection Fund (PEPF).

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India said PEPF will be on the lines of such mechanisms for depositors and investors set up by financial sector regulators.

SEBI mulls common advertisement code for stakeholders

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) proposed to bring in a common advertisement code for entities it regulates, according to a consultation paper. The markets watchdog seeks to simplify regulation of advertisements and reduce compliance costs for small entities.

The regulator proposed

to allow celebrity endorsements for brands or entities subject to certain prescribed conditions and appropriate disclaimers.

Further, SEBI proposes to shift from prior approval for advertisements to post-issuance reporting model.

The proposals once adopted will be implemented by amending SEBI (Intermediaries Regulations), 2008. Comments can be made till July 14.

Aurobindo Pharma gets U.S. FTC nod to buy Lannett Company

N. Ravi Kumar
HYDERABAD

The U.S. Federal Trade Commission (FTC) has approved Aurobindo Pharma’s proposed acquisition of Pennsylvania-based generic pharmaceutical firm Lannett Company.

Valued at \$250 million on a cash-free, debt-free basis and inclusive of normalised working capital, the transaction is expected to close before June, Aurobindo Pharma said adding subsidiary, Aurobindo

Pharma USA received the FTC approval.

Lannett specialises in the development and commercialisation of a diversified portfolio of complex, non-opioid controlled substances. The acquisition would significantly expand Aurobindo USA’s product offering while adding a U.S.-based manufacturing facility to its network.

FTC terms

Separately, the FTC said Aurobindo had to divest

four generic pharmaceutical products to Quagen Pharmaceuticals, a generic drugmaker. The move is to protect American patients from higher drug costs.

The order follows a complaint stating without the divestitures, the acquisition would increase the likelihood of Aurobindo unilaterally exercising market power in these four drug markets while the remaining competitors could engage in coordinated interaction, potentially raising the cost of generic drugs.

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU



Nandan Nilekani

As the industry is going through a major technology transition, Infosys is collaborating with 90% of its top 200 clients on their AI journey, which positioned the tech major well to tap into an AI-first services opportunity of \$300-400 billion by 2030, said Chairman Nandan Nilekani.

He was addressing shareholders during the company’s 45th AGM here on Tuesday. “The AI deployment gap in our large enterprise clients is real, and closing that gap is where the work is. AI will not replace companies like ours. It will amplify those who move with purpose and adapt with speed,” Mr. Nilekani said adding that more than three years after GenAI’s launch, Infosys remained more relevant than ever and was well-positioned for the decade ahead.

“The defining opportunity lies in integrating intelligent AI systems with mission-critical enterprise platforms. The greatest value will come from combining the world of models and agents with traditional transaction systems that continue to underpin enterprise operations. That convergence is where the next wave of opportunities would emerge,” he said.

Mr. Nilekani further said that the AI era required fresh learning and new ‘mental models’ and the company was systematical-

ly building talent for the new era.

Infosys recruited more than 20,000 college graduates during FY2026 and ended with a workforce of over 3,25,000 employees, Mr. Nilekani added.

Highlighting the company’s performance, he said fiscal 2026 had been a year of disciplined execution and resilience for Infosys, even as the external environment continued to evolve.

The company delivered \$20.2 billion in revenue, growing 3.1% in constant currency, while maintaining a strong adjusted operating margin of 21% and generated \$3.7 billion free cash which is 112.6% of net profit. This was the second consecutive year the company had generated free cash flows of more than 100% of net profit, he said.

“Large deal TCV for fiscal 2026 was at \$14.9 billion, with 55% being net new. This reflects the strong trust our clients have in us and relevance of our strategy, and provides a robust foundation to build on in the months ahead,” he explained.

Office of the Engineer-in-Chief (Civil), Odisha
Nirman Soudha, Unit-V, Bhubaneswar
Invitations For Bids (IFB)
File No. B-I-Tourism-02/2023 Lr. No.-20220 Bhubaneswar, the 22nd June, 2026
Invitation For Bids - Bid Identification No. CE-Bldg-II-17/2026-27
1. The Chief Engineer, Buildings-II (I/c), Odisha, Bhubaneswar, on behalf of Governor of Odisha, invites percentage rate bids in double cover system in ONLINE MODE only, for the work, "ReDevelopment Lord Guteswar Temple in Bolpariguda Block of Koraput District" as detailed below.
2. Nature of work : Building Works
3. No. of work : 01 No.
4. Bid Cost : ₹.10,000/-
5. Class of Contractor : 'A' / Special
6. Availability of Bid Documents in the website : From dt.29.06.2026 to 17:00 Hours of dt.14.07.2026.
7. Date of Opening of Bid : Dt. 15.07.2026 at 11:30 AM
8. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website: https://tendersodisha.gov.in. Any addendum/corrigendum/cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website only.
Chief Engineer, Buildings-II (I/c), Odisha
34001/382/2627 OIPR-34001/341171/126-27/0032

GUJARAT URJA VIKAS NIGAM LTD
CIN U40109GJ2004SGC045195
ISO 9001:2015 Certified Company
Sardar Patel Vidyut Bhavan, Racecourse, Vadodara 390007
PBX: (0265) 2310582-86, www.guvnl.com
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender Search Code on ISN-ETS: GUVNL-2026- TN000002
GUVNL invites tenders for setting up of 450 MW / 900 MWh Standalone Battery Energy Storage Systems in Gujarat under Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding with Viability Gap Funding supported through PSDF (Phase-IX) followed by e-reverse auction. For tender documents, please visit the website www.bharat-electronictender.com and www.guvnl.com. The last date of online bid submission is 13-Jul-2026.
General Manager (Power Trading)

राष्ट्रीय जैव विविधता प्राधिकरण
NATIONAL BIODIVERSITY AUTHORITY
(Statutory Body of Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of India)
5वां तल, टाइसल बायो पार्क, सीएसआईआर रोड, तारमणि, चेन्नई - 600113. तमिलनाडु, भारत
5th Floor, TICEL Bio Park, CSIR Road, Taramani, Chennai - 600113. Tamilnadu, India
CALL FOR APPLICATIONS
Engagement of Professionals under the GoI-UNDP-GEF-7 Biodiversity Project
Applications are invited for the engagement of qualified professionals on a Temporary basis at the National levels for implementation of the Government of India-UNDP-GEF-7 Biodiversity Project. The positions are purely contractual and project-specific, aimed at supporting effective execution of project activities across relevant thematic and geographical areas.
1 NATIONAL LEVEL - MoEFCC, New Delhi
i. Admin, Operations and Finance Officer 01 post
2 NATIONAL LEVEL - NBA, Chennai
i. National Project Officer (Biodiversity Expert) 01 post
ii. Procurement, Admin and Finance Officer 01 post
The interested and eligible candidates may apply in the prescribed format on or before 24.07.2026 to The Administrative Officer, National Biodiversity Authority, 5th Floor, TICEL Bio-Park, CSIR Road, Taramani, Chennai - 600113, Tamil Nadu.
For detailed notification, application format, eligibility criteria and other details, please visit the National Biodiversity Authority website www.nbaindia.org
Sd/-
Administrative Officer
NBA, Chennai

VIKING MARCH

Haaland on the double again as Norway enters the round of 32



GETTY IMAGES

Erling Haaland scored his second World Cup brace in a row as Norway beat Senegal 3-2 in East Rutherford on Monday to punch its ticket to the last 32. Norway substitute Marcus Holmgren Pedersen struck late in the first half before Haaland doubled the lead shortly after the break.

COMEBACK WIN

Algeria finds the target twice off corner-kicks to edge Jordan



AP

Algeria scored off two corner-kicks in the second half to defeat Jordan 2-1 on Monday to bolster its chances of entering the knockouts of the World Cup. Substitute Nadhir Benbouali headed in a corner-kick in the 69th minute and Amine Gouiri netted in the 82nd to give Algeria its first win at the showpiece since 2014.

REPORTING FOR DUTY

USA midfielder Pulisic returns to training after calf injury



REUTERS

Christian Pulisic returned to training with teammates on Monday after missing USA's most recent match of the World Cup with a calf injury. The team gave no formal update on the status of the AC Milan midfielder, who has been limited to one dynamic half of play in the unbeaten Americans' home World Cup.

EVER THE TEAM MAN

Beyond anything, I'm so happy for the win: record-breaker Messi



AP

There were moments when I was really angry about missing the penalty, but I was able to make up for it. Beyond anything I'm so happy for the win. It was huge and difficult. I'm enjoying this moment and craving to enjoy with my teammates — Argentina's Lionel Messi after becoming the highest goal-getter in World Cups.



Roaring back: Ronaldo silenced his detractors with two first-half strikes in Portugal's thumping win over the central Asian side. AFP

Ronaldo comes to the party as Portugal routs Uzbekistan

The 41-year-old becomes the first man to score in six editions of the quadrennial extravaganza; the 5-0 victory eases pressure on the European powerhouse while the debutant slumps to a second straight defeat in Group K

FIFA WORLD CUP

Avon Sengupta
HOUSTON

For generations of Uzbek football fans, Cristiano Ronaldo was the dream. His shirts filled the bazaars of Tashkent and Samarkand, and his celebrations were copied in every playground. On Tuesday, those supporters finally had the chance to watch their own nation face the man. For many in the stands, it was a dream and a disappointment rolled into one. Ronaldo found his scoring boots, but the goals came against the country that had long celebrated him from afar. He scored twice in a 5-0 victory for Portugal, which found the response it desperately needed through the man who remains, as ever, the central character in every team he plays for. In the sixth minute, Ronaldo finally found the goal he had been searching for.

Reacting quickest to a Joao Cancelo cutback, he darted ahead of his marker and bundled home the finish that put Portugal's World Cup campaign back on track.

The release of tension was impossible to miss from the stands. Relief and defiance flashed across the impassive face of the veteran as he sprinted towards the bench in celebration. Arms outstretched, he embraced teammates and staff, a response directed as much at his critics as the crowd.

Nuno Mendes doubled Portugal's advantage soon after, whipping in a free-kick through a gap in the Uzbek barrier. It was a goal that would have left Uzbek coach Fabio Cannavaro, the last defender to win the Ballon d'Or, unimpressed with the composition of his defensive wall.

Uzbekistan briefly believed it had found a way back. In the 29th minute, Aziz Ganiev unleashed a stunning strike from out-

side the box to beat an outstretched Diogo Costa. But a VAR review ruled it out after officials had spotted a foul on Cancelo in the build-up.

Ronaldo struck again in the 39th minute, the move beginning with a trademark Bruno Fernandes surge. Spotting his captain's run, the Manchester United midfielder rolled a precise through ball into space and Ronaldo, staying a whisker aside, calmly tucked his finish beyond Abdughohid Nematov.

Portugal's fourth arrived on the hour mark when Fernandes' corner caused chaos in the six-yard box. Ronaldo's near-post flick brushed Abdulkodir Khusanov and spun beyond Nematov for an own goal causing further misery to Uzbekistan. A one-touch finish from Rafael Leao, three minutes from time, added to the scoreline.

The Uzbek faithful had finally met their hero, but the reunion brought more pain than joy.

Table and fixtures

As the teams head into their final group games, a look at how they are placed and who they meet



Group A	M	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Points
Mexico (Q)	2	2	0	0	3	0	3	6
South Korea	2	1	0	1	2	2	0	3
Czechia	2	0	1	1	2	3	-1	1
South Africa	2	0	1	1	1	3	-2	1

Thursday's matches: Czechia vs. Mexico and South Africa vs. South Korea, both 6.30 a.m. IST

Group B	M	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Points
Canada	2	1	1	0	7	1	6	4
Switzerland	2	1	1	0	5	2	3	4
Bosnia & Herzegovina	2	0	1	1	2	5	-3	1
Qatar	2	0	1	1	1	7	-6	1

Thursday's matches: Switzerland vs. Canada and Bosnia & Herzegovina vs. Qatar, both 00.30 a.m. IST

Group C	M	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Points
Brazil	2	1	1	0	4	1	3	4
Morocco	2	1	1	0	2	1	1	4
Scotland	2	1	0	1	1	1	0	3
Haiti (E)	2	0	0	2	0	4	-4	0

Thursday's matches: Scotland vs. Brazil and Morocco vs. Haiti, both 3.30 a.m. IST

* The top two from each group and the eight best third-placed sides will advance to the round of 32

T20 WORLD CUP

P.K. Ajith Kumar
MANCHESTER

There are talks now here in England of a 1976 style summer. It was so hot, riverbeds and taps dried up. There is a heatwave now, too, with warnings of extreme heat. All that didn't stop the Women in Blue from sweating out for hours at Old Trafford on Tuesday.

Smriti Mandhana played more of her pleasing shots, than the ungainly one that cost her — and India — dear against South Africa on the very ground on Sunday. The bowlers attempted to hit the stumps, and succeeded.

They should be able to do more in the upcoming matches, which India cannot afford to lose. After that disappointing defeat to the Proteas, Harman-



Big concern: Jemimah has failed to get going so far. AFP

preet Kaur's women are not in an enviable position when it comes to clinching a place in the semifinals from the Group of Death.

Australia, which has played some expectedly dominant cricket, is almost there. The South Africans, after scoring what was their fifth win in the last six

T20s against India, should be less nervous than India, as they have already played — and lost to — Australia and have lesser weights as opponents in the group stage. The Indians, on the other hand, will play Australia in the last league match.

But, before that, they

Agence France-Presse

PHILADELPHIA

Kylian Mbappe marked his 100th cap by scoring two more World Cup goals on Monday as France eased to a 3-0 win over Iraq in a game delayed by two hours by a severe storm.

The 2022 finalist is already certain of reaching the last 32 after notching up two wins from two games in Group I.

Mbappe opened the scoring in the 14th minute and added another nine

THE RESULTS

Group J: Jordan 1 (Al-Rashdan 36) lost to Algeria 2 (Benbouali 69, Gouiri 82). Group I: France 3 (Mbappe 14, 54, Dembele 66) bt Iraq 0; Norway 3 (Holmgren Pedersen 43, Haaland 48, 58) bt Senegal 2 (I. Saar 53, 90+3). Group K: Portugal 5 (Ronaldo 6, 39, Mendes 17, Nematov 60-og, Leao 87) bt Uzbekistan 0.

minutes into the second half, with last year's Ballon d'Or winner Ousmane Dembele getting the other goal.

Mbappe moved to 16 World Cup goals in his career, two behind Lionel Messi who set a new record of 18 goals by netting twice for Argentina against Austria.

Mbappe is level on the all-time list of World Cup goals with Germany's Miroslav Klose.

Graham Arnold's side was dealt a blow as captain and striker Aymen Hussein had to come off with just 26 minutes gone. Iraq is starting at the prospect of an early exit.

I've always said Messi is no slouch. For me, Leo is the best footballer of all time!

MIROSLAV KLOSE

Even the greats before him cannot match the complete body of work

ZLATAN IBRAHIMOVIC

India wins a thriller, extends domination over Pakistan

PRO LEAGUE

Press Trust of India
LONDON

India defeated Pakistan 4-3 in a pulsating FIH Pro League match here on Tuesday, extending its decade-long unbeaten streak against the arch-rival in international hockey.

The victory lifted India to seventh in the standings and came in the first meeting between the two sides since the 2024 Asian Champions Trophy in China, where the Harmanpreet Singh-led side had prevailed 2-1.

Ahmad Nadeem gave Pakistan the lead in the eighth minute through a penalty corner before Abhishek (22nd) struck from a field effort to draw parity.

Nilakanta Sharma then gave India the lead con-



Field day: Sukhjeet doubled India's lead. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

verting a penalty corner in the 24th minute as the Harmanpreet Singh-led side went into the breather with a 2-1 lead.

India extended its lead in the 40th minute through a field goal from Sukhjeet Singh and then Rajinder Singh made it 4-1 from a penalty corner in the 52nd. But Pakistan came back

strongly in the final quarter, with Abu Mahmood (53rd) and Moin Shakeel (60th) scoring from penalty corners but it was not enough.

The result: India 4 (Abhishek 22, Nilakanta Sharma 24-pc, Sukhjeet Singh 40, Rajinder Singh 52-pc) bt Pakistan 3 (Ahmad Nadeem 8-pc, Abu Mahmood 53-pc, Moin Shakeel 60-pc).

Today's match

England vs. West Indies

Lord's, 11 p.m. IST

HEAD-TO-HEAD

Played: 32

England 22 vs. West Indies 10

LIVE ON STAR SPORTS 1 & JIOHOTSTAR

have to think about the match against Bangladesh here on Thursday.

And there are areas of concern. Like the middle-order, for instance.

Smriti and Shafali Verma have given good starts. Even against South Africa, they were shaping up nicely, until Smriti played that forgettable shot against Marizanne Kapp.

Down the order, Richa Ghosh continues to be one of the most feared batters. She has handled the pres-

sure of being the only finisher rather well.

But, the space between the openers and Richa is not a very happy one. The likes of Jemimah Rodrigues and the captain herself have to bat a bit deeper. Given the fact that this Indian side doesn't have as many quality all-rounders like Australia, the middle-order needs to do more.

When it comes to bowling, Shree Charani needs more support, especially after the unfortunate injury to Shreyanka Patil.

Tuesday's scores:

Group B: Scotland 131/7 in 20 overs (Darcey Carter 72 n.o., Amelia Kerr 3/17, Sophie Devine 2/19) lost to New Zealand 132/4 in 18.2 overs (Izzy Sharp 62, Brooke Halliday 41 n.o., Kathryn Bryce 2/13, Rachel Slater 2/22). Toss: New Zealand; PoM: Sharp. Ireland 130/5 in 20 overs (Gaby Lewis 59) lost to Sri Lanka 134/1 in 15.3 overs (Chamari Athapaththu 106 n.o.). Toss: Sri Lanka; PoM: Chamari.

INBRIEF



Sooryavanshi receives his first Team India jersey

Fifteen-year-old sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi received his first official Team India jersey on Tuesday. Sooryavanshi was named in India's T20I squad for the tours of Ireland and England, as well as the Asian Games, after topping the IPL 2026 run chart. The BCCI released a video of the blue jersey being delivered to him, calling it “the moment the nation has been waiting for”.

Shedge replaces Nitish in India's T20I squads

Suryansh Shedge has replaced Nitish Kumar in India's squads for the upcoming T20I series against Ireland and England. Nitish reported left quadriceps discomfort after the third ODI against Afghanistan on Saturday.

Tucker named Ireland T20I captain ahead of India series

Lorcan Tucker was named Ireland captain ahead of the two T20Is against India on June 26 and 28.

The squad: Lorcan Tucker (Capt., wk), Ross Adair, Ben Calitz, Gareth Delany, George Dockrell, Stephen Doheny (wk), Matthew Humphreys, Gavin Hoeny, Matthew Holland, Liam McCarthy, Jai Moondra, Harry Tector, Tim Tector, Reuben Wilson.

Aussie Patterson named Indian rowing team coach

Rowing Federation of India has confirmed the appointment of Australian Antony Patterson as coach of the national team. The 60-year-old has coached national teams of Japan and Mexico apart from clubs in England and South Africa. “Paterson will be with the team till the Asian Games and if his performance is satisfactory, we will consider retaining him till the 2028 LA Olympics,” Balaji Maradapa, president of the federation, said in Chennai on Tuesday.

Equitas Small Finance Bank emerges the champion

Equitas Small Finance Bank defeated Hangover XI by 12 runs in the final to clinch the SSWCA 30 overs league cup on Tuesday.

The scores: Equitas Small Finance Bank 222/8 in 30 overs (Kathick Chellappa 76, Srivatsan 67, Rohit 36, Srivatsan 4/49, Giri 3/39) bt Hangover XI 210 in 29.4 overs. (Shiva 77, Abhishek 55, Venkat 3/33, Sathish 3/33). **Special awards: Best batter:** Kathick Chellappa (Equitas); **Best bowler:** Sathish (Equitas); **Player-of-the-series:** Karthick Chellappa.

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA first division league, Jolly Rovers vs. Grand Slam (Tagore); Sea Hawks vs. Vijay (Gojan-A); Nelson vs. Young Stars (Gojan-B); Swaraj vs. Pristine (TI-Murugappa); SKM vs. Singam Puli (Wahe Guru-A); MRC-A vs. Globe Trotters (S.V. HS ground), day three, 9.30 a.m.

Delhi HC directs AITA to expedite election

Sports Bureau
BENGALURU

The Delhi High Court directed the interim Executive Committee of the All India Tennis Association (AITA) to expedite the process of amending its Constitution and bringing it in line with the National Sports Governance Act, 2025 and National Sports Governance Rules, 2026. The Court said that a fresh election under the amended Constitution will have to be held on or before September 30, 2026.

The nudge was part of the interim order passed on June 18 in an appeal filed by the AITA, Somdev Devvarman and Purav Raja, against the judgment delivered in late April which removed the stay on results of the AITA election held in September 2024 and appointed Justice (Retd.) Gita Mittal as AITA administrator.

TAMIL NADU ROUND-UP



Golden four: C.C. Sennila, Abdullah, J.T. Sachin, Sreeswar Shijo with their reward.

Hatsun Badminton Centre shuttlers reap it rich Hatsun Badminton Centre shuttlers secured four gold, four silver, and three bronze medals across three State-ranking tournaments in Kancheepuram, Chennai, and Ernakulam. At the sub-junior (u-15) event in Kancheepuram, Abdullah clinched the singles and mixed doubles gold with C.C. Sennila while K. Selvamadhan claimed singles silver. J.T. Sachin and Lesslee Roy won singles gold and silver, respectively, at the u-19 event in Chennai. Sreeswar Shijo (u-15 singles

title), J. Tanya Abigail (u-19 girls' doubles silver), Aaditri Kannan (u-15 girls' singles bronze and doubles silver), Adlin Jefima (u-19 girls' doubles bronze), and S. Neha (u-19 mixed doubles bronze) added to the medal tally at the Yonex Sunrise YUMMS Kerala sub-junior tournament in Ernakulam.

TN govt. signs MoU with JSW Sports' IIS The Tamil Nadu government has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with JSW Sports' Inspire Institute of Sport (IIS) for

knowledge sharing, Sports Minister Aadhav Arjuna announced at a function to celebrate Olympic Day at the Nehru Indoor Stadium in Chennai on Tuesday. The tie-up is expected to provide TN athletes access to structured mentorship, technical support and knowledge-sharing from IIS. Manisha Malhotra, president of IIS, said: “We have knowledge sharing in disciplines such as athletics, judo and boxing. “But the nitty-gritties of what we are going to do and how we are going to go ahead has still not been discussed”.

Sport

Commitment thy name is Tilak

After captaining the triumphant India-A side in the island nation, the ‘Falcon’ flies back to produce a memorable knock in TG20

CRICKET

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

Tilak Varma stood at the summit on Sunday, leading India to the tri-series title in Sri Lanka. By the end of the day, he was back in Hyderabad.

For most players, the next step after an international triumph would be rest, recovery and a moment for it to soak in. Tilak, however, chose differently. He was back on the field, this time for the maiden season of TG20, Telangana's domestic T20 league, to captain his franchise Medak Falcons.

“Tilak came to meet the players at the team hotel on Sunday evening and returned the next morning to



Take a bow! Tilak's skill and will came to the fore as he led his team home in a big chase. NAGARA GOPAL

have one-on-one conversations with them. He told them to enjoy the occasion,” T. Ravi Teja, Falcons’

designated skipper, revealed to *The Hindu*. A stacked calendar notwithstanding, Tilak priori-

tised motivating the squad and dangling perhaps the most irresistible carrot in the T20 universe – possi-

ble trials with IPL teams for standout performers.

Warangal Warriors smashed its way to 258 for seven, riding on Aman Rao's 48-ball 142.

With his bowlers stumped for answers, Tilak brought himself on and struck twice. Yet, his defining contribution was still to come.

Guiding his teammates Faced with a towering target, Tilak, at No. 3, found himself in the middle in the second over. Through every partnership, however brief, Tilak remained in constant conversation with his inexperienced teammates. He pushed relentlessly for twos and threes, showing the urgency and intensity of a batter playing the most important knock of his career. Tilak's half-century ar-

rived off just 22 balls and 20 deliveries later, he raised his bat for a hundred. The emotions burst through, along with his signature celebration, after he struck the winning run.

His enthusiasm was so infectious that the top five batters maintained a strike rate of over 150. Tilak himself went at a rate of 225 (136 n.o., 56b, 14x4, 8x6).

There was no time for more celebrations as Tilak left immediately after the game to catch a flight to Mumbai. He will then travel to Ireland for the two-match T20I series later this week.

For a player rated highly for his skill and commitment, Monday's incredible effort was a reminder that leadership begins long before the toss and extends far beyond the scorecard.

Shivam's double century powers Nelson to a mammoth total

TNCA FIRST DIVISION

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Shivam Singh slammed 219 (393b, 7x4, 6x6) to propel Nelson SC to 484 for nine declared in the first innings against Young Stars on day two of a third round TNCA I division league match here on Tuesday.

At Tagore, Abhinav Kannan's 127 ensured Grand Slam posted 279 against Jolly Rovers.

For Rovers, pacer Sandeep Warrior scalped five for 55.

Siddharth's 300th Singam Puli's left-arm spinner M. Siddharth claimed his 300th wicket in the first division league when he dismissed SKM CC opener



Shivam (Nelson, 219); Abhinav (Grand Slam, 127).

and skipper C. Hari Nishaanth.

The scores: **At Tagore:** Grand Slam 279 in 90.3 overs (Abhinav Kannan 127, Mohammed Adnan Khan 70, Sandeep Warrior 5/55) vs. Jolly Rovers 138/3 in 43 overs (R. Vimal Kumar 43, P. Khush Bardia 49). **At Gojan 'A':** Vijay 350 in 100 overs (Pradosh Ranjan Paul 65, B. Aparajith 122, Nidhish S. Rajagopal 49, H. Trilok Nag 4/81) vs. Sea Hawks 202/9 in 78 overs (B. Sachin 45, M. Vishal 48). **At Gojan 'B':** Nelson 484/9 decl. in 142 overs (Shivam Singh 219, Swapnil K. Singh 55, Sunny Sandhu 92, B.K. Kishore 4/123) vs. Young Stars 95/0 in 35 overs (M.



Warrior (Rovers, 5/55); Ashwanth (Swaraj, 104).

Mithul Raj 59 batting) **At TI-Murugappa:** Swaraj 378 in 132.3 overs (T. Vijay Abimanyu 68, Siddarth Prakash 71, Anuraag Rajesh Nair 46, L. Ramnath 54, Ashwanth Valthapa 104) vs. Pristine 129/4 in 45 overs (Siddharth Mahadevan 50). **At Wahe Guru 'A':** Singam Puli 392 in 132.3 overs (K. Aashiq 91, U. Muklesh 76, R. Ram Arvindh 45, Rahil Shah 4/106) vs. SKM CC 116/2 in 41 overs (C. Hari Nishaanth 65). **At S.V. High School:** MRC 'A' 438 in 120.2 overs (N.S. Chaturved 79, S. Mohamed Ali 45, M. Boopathi Vaishna Kumar 74, G.K. Shyam 52, Vijay Shankar 96) vs. Globe Trotters 136/2 in 31 overs (D. Santhosh Kumar 96 batting).

DC and LSG complete Pant, Kuldeep trade

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

Rishabh Pant has moved back to Delhi Capitals while Lucknow Super Giants has acquired the services of left-arm wrist-spinner Kuldeep Yadav, the Indian Premier League announced on Tuesday. It is one of the most high-profile trades in IPL history.

Pant's return to Capitals, where he spent eight seasons from 2016 to 2024, follows a disastrous two-year stint with LSG.

Heading in the other direction is Kuldeep, who was off-colour for Capitals in the recently-concluded edition. In 12 games, he claimed 10 wickets at an economy of 10.29.

INTER-DISTRICT WOMEN'S

Hashini's unbeaten ton puts Krishnagiri in the semifinals KRISHNAGIRI: K. Hashini's unbeaten 156 (154b, 15x4) propelled Krishnagiri to a 134-run win over Dindigul in the TNCA inter-district women's tournament quarterfinals here on Tuesday.

The scores: Quarterfinals: At Krishnagiri: Krishnagiri 255/4 in 50 overs (K. Hashini 156 n.o., M. Sudheshna 43) bt Dindigul 121 in 38.4 overs (P. Tanushri 3/11, A. Ayesha 3/29).

At Salem: Ranipet 126 in 36.1 overs (S. Rinaaz 50, J. Mohana Priya 38, S.J. Rithika 3/31, S. Vaishnavi 3/7) lost to Salem 127/4 in 24.4 overs (S. Vaishnavi 61).

At Coimbatore: Madurai 88 in

48.1 overs (Sweata 3/16) lost to Coimbatore 89/5 in 27.1 overs. **At Erode:** Erode 95 in 29.2 overs (S.K. Anritha 3/23) lost to Thiruvallur 98/3 in 23.4 overs (M. Hashini Keerthika 34, S. Krishnagiri, Nandhana 31 156 n.o.). n.o.). *Match reduced to 46 overs per side.*

LIVE TELECAST

INTER-DISTRICT U-19

Ranipet to take on Thiruvallur in the title decider

DINDIGUL: V.S. Kousik's 103 (273b, 11x4) and his 112-run third-wicket partnership with E. Raghav (61) were the highlights as Ranipet posted a 10-wicket victory over Salem in the TNCA inter-district under-19 semifinal here on Tuesday. K.P. Thaswin Kumar starred with 102 (195b, 12x4, 2x6) as Thiruvallur qualified for the title clash with a 72-run lead in the other semifinal against Chengalpattu at Theni.



Kousik (Ranipet, 103); Thaswin (Thiruvallur, 102).

The scores (semifinals): At Theni: Chengalpattu 153 & 77/5 in 14 overs (Akshay Barath 47 n.o., K. Karmegam 3/37) drew with Thiruvallur 225 in 69 overs (K.P. Thaswin Kumar 102, R. Sohan Pushparaj 52, B. Sandeep 4/87). **At Dindigul:** Salem 148 & 108 in 36.3 overs (Pratheswaran 51, V.S. Varun 3/29) lost to Ranipet 241/6 in 90 overs (V.S. Kousik 103, E. Raghav 61, V. Nakul Varshan 3/90) & 17/0 in 3.3 overs.

Indian athletes make last-gasp effort for Asian Games qualification

Y.B. Sarangi
BHUBANESWAR

A sparking new track, despite shipping issues in the Strait of Hormuz due to the Iran war, at the Kalinga Stadium here may offer surprises for the country's elite athletes when they seek to qualify for the Asian Games at the only selection opportunity, the National inter-State athletics meet, starting here on Wednesday.

Laying of the track, costing about ₹22 crore, finished on Monday. “I’ll have an idea about the track when I compete tomorrow [Wednesday] morning,” said 5000m National record holder Gulveer Singh. World championships finalist high jumper Sarvesh Kushare, who equalled his personal best 2.28m at the Federation meet in Ranchi, added: “I have competed



All in readiness: AFI officials and senior athletes after the press conference. BISWARANJAN ROUT

in these conditions before. I will give my best here.” Sprinter Animesh Kujur, who landed here on Tuesday after being part of India's gold-winning 4x100m men's team in the Asian Relays in China, had a clear target. “I hope to get back my (100m National) record,” said Kujur, who would compete in 100m and 200m.

Joint National record holder pole vaulters Dev Meena and Kuldeep Kumar wanted to repeat their Ranchi mark (5.45m) and qualify for the Asian. National record holders, quartermiler Vishal T.K., woman high jumper Pooja, are among the leading athletes who will be seen in action. Following her injury lay-

off, hurdler Jyothi Yarraji is making a comeback after a year.

Some top names, including former World and Olympic champion javelin thrower Neeraj Chopra, 100m National record holder Gurinder Singh, National record holder decathlete Tejaswin Shankar, have got exemption from the meet.

Is Catalunya a tipping point in a changing landscape?

No one could have left Barcelona thinking exactly the same way they arrived. For Ferrari, the weekend offered validation. For Mercedes, it provided a warning. For Hamilton, it delivered redemption. And for Formula One itself, it may have provided something even more valuable: a championship battle that suddenly feels alive again

Natalia Hannah Rice

Formula One likes to tell itself that every race counts the same. 25 points are available on a Sunday whether the paddock is in Melbourne, Monaco or Monza. Yet some weekends carry a significance that stretches beyond the numbers on the championship table. They trends, alter narratives and force teams to rethink what they thought they knew.

The 2026 Barcelona-Catalunya Grand Prix may have proved to be one such weekend. When Lewis Hamilton crossed the finish line to secure his first victory as a Ferrari driver, the result was significant enough on its own. The seven-time World Champion claimed the 106th victory of his career and handed Ferrari its first win of the season. More importantly, however, the race may have marked the point at which Formula One's competitive landscape began to shift. For much of the opening phase of the season, Mercedes appeared untouchable. Kimi Antonelli's remarkable rise had become the story of the championship, the 19-year-old building a commanding lead at the top of the standings. George Russell had provided consistent support, and Mercedes had set the pace from the start of Formula One's sweeping 2026 regulations. The championship seemed to be developing a familiar rhythm. Mercedes set the pace. The rest chased. Barcelona changed that.

Unique place

Historically, Catalunya has occupied a unique place in Formula One. Drivers often describe the Circuit de Barcelona-Catalunya as one of the most complete examinations of a racing car. Long corners expose aerodynamic weaknesses. Technical sections punish balance issues. Tyre degradation places a premium on race management. Unlike street circuits, where unusual circumstances can distort results, Barcelona tends to reveal the genuine competitive order.

That is precisely why teams have traditionally targeted the Spanish round with major upgrade packages. Engineers trust what they learn there. This year was no different. Ferrari arrived having spent the early part of the season chasing Mercedes, with Hamilton coming off the back of two second-place finishes at the Canadian and Monaco Grands Prix. He went into qualifying with relatively low expectations, having missed Friday's opening practice session to make way for an academy driver.

Instead, he produced a brilliant final lap to fall just 0.064 seconds short of Russell's pole position, securing his highest grid position since joining Ferrari and his first front-row start for the team. Hamilton himself admitted he was "really surprised" by the result, saying he genuinely hadn't expected to be fighting for the front row. Russell's own pole lap carried its own context. He had fallen 68 points behind his Mercedes teammate in the standings after failing to score points in the two Grands Prix before Barcelona, and needed a big weekend. He duly delivered one, producing a superb final lap to outpace Antonelli by around three tenths of a second and claim pole. It would prove to be his last clean shot at victory all weekend. Barcelona provided the clearest confirmation yet that Ferrari's underlying pace was strong. Hamilton's victory was not the product of luck alone. Ferrari's strategy was bold, but the pace underneath it was genuine.

The team pitted Hamilton early to

undercut Russell, then again on Lap 28 to undercut him a second time, with Mercedes choosing not to cover the move. Hamilton then built his advantage on fresher tyres before a Virtual Safety Car, triggered by Fernando Alonso's retirement, allowed him to take his final stop with minimal time loss and emerge in the lead with fresher rubber than the Mercedes cars behind him. He went on to win by close to 20 seconds. The result was a victory built on speed, race-long tyre management, and a fair amount of fortunate timing.

The significance extends beyond a single win. For the first time this season, Mercedes looked vulnerable. Antonelli's retirement, with four laps remaining and an apparent power unit issue, denied the championship leader what would have been a podium finish and cut his points advantage over Hamilton to 41. Mechanical failures are part of Formula One, but their timing can often shape a season. Until Barcelona, Antonelli's campaign had carried an air of inevitability. Instead, Barcelona reintroduced uncertainty.

Antonelli's failure was not an isolated data point, either. It was the second such retirement for Mercedes' factory team in three events, after Russell's car also failed while he was leading in Canada. Mercedes has since said it has traced the cause to the power unit's battery. Technical director James Allison said the issue "has laid a few Mercedes engine cars low over the season so far" and described the failures as "very, very painful," while team principal Toto Wolff said the team's reliability was "just not good enough." A single mechanical gremlin is a footnote. A diagnosed, recurring fault becomes a storyline rivals start planning around.

Hamilton's victory reduced the gap at the top of the standings and reminded the paddock that experience remains one of Formula One's most valuable assets. At 41, Hamilton became the oldest winner of a Grand Prix since Jack Brabham in 1970 and he reached that milestone a full 19 years after his first F1 win, for McLaren in 2007. The achievement was not simply a statistic. It was evidence that a driver many believed was entering the twilight of his career remains capable of shaping a championship. The emotional weight of the victory was impossible to ignore.

Since signing for Ferrari at the start of 2025, Hamilton had struggled to get to grips with the car, failing to score a single podium that year. There were encouraging signs once the new regulations arrived in 2026, with podiums in Canada and Monaco, but victory remained elusive. Questions inevitably emerged. Had Hamilton arrived too late and could Ferrari provide the machinery required for another title challenge.

Barcelona did not answer every question, but it provided the strongest response yet. Speaking on the team radio afterwards, an emotional Hamilton said: "Thank you so much for helping me achieve this dream. I just can't thank you enough... to my fans, thank you for continuing to remind me who I am. I couldn't have done this without you." More importantly, it transformed Ferrari from hopeful challenger into genuine contender. The broader significance of Catalunya



lies in what it revealed about the development race. The first season under a major regulation change often produces dramatic swings in competitiveness. Teams begin with imperfect understanding. Development pathways remain uncertain. Small discoveries can generate large gains. A concept that appears dominant in March can look ordinary by July. Barcelona suggested that Formula One may be entering exactly that phase. Mercedes remains the benchmark. Its advantage has not disappeared overnight. Russell secured pole position and ultimately finished second, underlining the team's continued strength. Yet the aura of invincibility has been broken. Rivals now possess tangible evidence that the silver cars can be beaten on merit. That psychological shift matters.

Championships are shaped as much by belief as by outright pace. A dominant team forces competitors into desperation. They gamble on radical developments, overreact to setbacks and lose confidence in their direction. Once dominance cracks, the equation changes. Teams become bolder. Drivers become more aggressive. Momentum begins to shift.

Ferrari is not the only team encouraged by Barcelona. McLaren continues to linger within striking distance. Lando Norris inherited the final podium spot after Antonelli's late retirement. It was his second podium of the season, coming after he had failed to score points at the previous two Grands Prix, on a weekend where McLaren looked more competitive than it had in those earlier rounds. The reigning World Champion may not yet possess the fastest package on a given Sunday, but Formula One history is full of title fights transformed by sustained pressure rather than outright superiority.

The race also delivered a piece of motor-sport history beyond the championship fight: with Hamilton, Russell and Norris filling the podium, it marked the first all-British podium since 1968. The European segment of the calendar has often acted as a dividing line within a season. Early races establish expectations. The summer races determine whether those expectations survive. Barcelona sits at the entrance to that stretch. Austria is next on the calendar. These circuits demand different strengths, exposing different weaknesses and creating fresh opportunities for development gains. Teams will arrive armed with new data collected from Catalunya. Engineers will spend long nights interpreting what they learned. Drivers will leave with altered perceptions of their chances. No one leaves Barcelona thinking exactly the same way they arrived. For Ferrari, the weekend offered validation. For Mercedes, it provided a warning. For Hamilton, it delivered redemption. And for Formula One itself, it may have provided something even more valuable: a championship battle that suddenly feels alive again.

Formula One has a habit of overturning conclusions just when certainty appears within reach. Yet, some races resonate long after the podium celebrations end. They become reference points, moments that historians revisit when explaining how a season evolved. If the 2026 championship develops into the multi-team fight many had hoped for, Barcelona may be remembered as the place where everything changed.

THE GIST

The championship seemed to be developing a familiar rhythm. Mercedes set the pace. The rest chased. Barcelona changed that

The race also delivered a piece of motor-sport history beyond the championship fight: with Hamilton, Russell and Norris filling the podium, it marked the first all-British podium since 1968

If the 2026 championship develops into the multi-team fight many had hoped for, Barcelona may be remembered as the place where everything changed



The strange link between AI hallucination and creativity

A setting called temperature governs how adventurous an LLM's outputs are: the higher the temperature, the more likely the model reaches for the less likely options and surprises the user; this is the dial that one turns up when seeking a poem instead of a weather report; the trouble is that the same dial governs hallucinations

Viraj Kulkarni

In the prologue to his 1989 book *The Emperor's New Mind*, the Nobel laureate Roger Penrose narrates a story. At a grand public ceremony, an ultimate supercomputer is switched on for the first time before a packed auditorium. It is the most powerful machine ever built, designed to answer any question put to it. The presenter invites the audience to ask its very first question, but no one volunteers. Everyone is afraid of looking foolish before the intelligent machine. Then a young boy named Adam, who has grown up among computers and is not intimidated by them, raises his hand and asks the first question. There the prologue ends on a cliff-hanger. We are never told what the question is.

Penrose used this story to introduce a deeper argument about the limits of computation and the nature of human understanding. He contends that there are truths a formal mathematical machine cannot reach no matter how powerful it becomes.

But reading this story a decade ago, long before ChatGPT or Claude existed, brought a different question to mind: what if the ability to answer every question correctly is not always a virtue? What if some of the qualities we value most, such as imagination and creativity, depend on our ability to venture beyond what is already known?

Today, as we build machines that can answer questions, write essays, generate code, and analyse data, that question feels very relevant.

Natural instinct

For all their remarkable capabilities, these systems sometimes make things up. We call this hallucination. Ordinarily, a hallucination means to see or hear something that is not there. In artificial intelligence (AI), a model hallucinates when it produces an answer that sounds plausible but is factually wrong. It may invent a citation, misstate a number, fabricate a legal case, or attribute a quote to the wrong person.

This is not a minor flaw. In medicine, law, finance, science, and journalism, hallucinations can be dangerous. A medical chatbot that invents advice is not being imaginative but unsafe. A legal tool that fabricates case law is being unreliable.

Our natural instinct is to want to eliminate hallucinations but this is harder than it appears. Large language models (LLMs) do not work like databases, storing facts in neat rows and columns, and retrieving the right answer when asked. They are trained on enormous collections of text and learn statistical patterns in language. When prompted, they generate a response by predicting what will come next, one piece at a time.



As AI models are encouraged to be more adventurous, their creativity and hallucinations increase together. AEDRIAN SALAZAR/UNSPLASH

An LLM generates text one word at a time, each word a probability drawn from patterns it absorbed during training. A setting called the temperature governs how adventurous those draws are. If the temperature is low, the model will pick the safest, most predictable next word and produce an accurate and dull output. If the temperature is higher, the model will reach into the less likely options and begin to surprise you. This is the dial you turn up when you want a poem instead of a weather report.

The trouble is that the same dial governs hallucinations. A 2025 study reported evidence that creativity and hallucination tend to increase together as models are encouraged to be more adventurous and explore regions of lower probabilities. In other words, the model that dares to write something genuinely new is the same model that dares to make something up.

A different 2025 study found that the mechanisms that let these systems produce novel, imaginative text by departing from learned patterns are the same mechanisms that open the door to hallucinations.

It is also easier said than done to simply build a better model that does one without the other. In September 2025,

researchers at OpenAI and Georgia Tech argued that hallucinations are not bugs to be patched but a statistical inevitability of how these systems are trained and tested. Models are rewarded, like students in an exam hall, for guessing rather than admitting ignorance. A confident wrong answer may score better than an honest "I don't know".

Scrubbed of surprise

The second study went further, and this is where Penrose returns to the room. Drawing on the foundational theorems of computer science about the limits of computation, laid by the work of Alan Turing and Kurt Gödel, they argued that no computable model can ever be universally correct. There will always be questions on which any given machine must fail. Hallucination, thus seen, is not a flaw in our engineering but a long shadow cast by the limits of computation itself.

Penrose used just this family of ideas to argue that human thinking cannot be reduced to mere computation. Many philosophers and computer scientists think he is wrong but modern researchers are pointing at the same wall from the other side. Penrose said machines are bounded, human minds are not. Modern

researchers say machines are bounded, and here is the proof. Both agree that the wall is there.

We are pouring extraordinary effort into making these systems truthful, and we should. But if accuracy and imagination draw from the same well, a machine perfectly scrubbed of error might also be a machine scrubbed of surprise. This may also teach us something about ourselves. Human beings also hallucinate in a softer, broader sense all the time. We imagine futures. We invent stories. We see patterns. We form hypotheses. Much of this is wrong – but some of it becomes science, art, philosophy, and technology. The difference is that human societies developed methods to discipline imagination. Science uses experiments. Journalism uses verification. Philosophy uses argument.

Perhaps AI needs something similar: not a ban on hallucinations but better institutions of verification around it.

(Viraj Kulkarni is an entrepreneur and AI advisor who has been building, deploying, and scaling AI systems since 2012. He studied computer science at University of California, Berkeley. kulkarni.viraj@gmail.com)

THE GIST

For all their remarkable capabilities, AI systems sometimes make things up, called hallucinations

Ordinarily, a hallucination means to see or hear something that is not there

In AI, a model hallucinates when it produces an answer that sounds plausible but is factually wrong

A system may invent a citation, misstate a number, fabricate a legal case, or attribute a quote to the wrong person

But if accuracy and imagination draw from the same well, a machine perfectly scrubbed of error might also be a machine scrubbed of surprise

The difference between AI systems and human societies is that the latter developed methods to discipline imagination: science uses experiments, journalism uses verification and philosophy uses argument

BIG SHOT



Behind the veil: Children take shelter from the sun at a primary school in Grabels, near Montpellier, France, on Tuesday, where the Racine programme is being tested to reduce temperatures. The Racine programme aims at adapting primary schools to heatwaves with a set of sun protection, refreshments, and ventilation. AFP

WHAT IS IT?

Carbon isotopes: clocks of sorts

Reuters

Scientists studying the comet 3I/ATLAS have determined that this interstellar visitor formed an estimated 12 billion years ago in a primordial planetary system, and has a composition unlike anything in our solar system.

An evaluation of the chemical make-up of 3I/ATLAS, only the third interstellar object ever spotted in the solar system, provided guidance about the physical and chemical conditions in the planetary system where it formed, the researchers said.

They added that 3I/ATLAS appears to have been born in a much colder environment (-243C) than the one in which the earth and other bodies in our solar system formed roughly 4.5 billion years ago. They said it has travelled a vast distance since it was somehow expelled from its home planetary system.

The researchers measured the ratio of isotopes — different versions of chemical elements such as hydrogen and carbon — observed on 3I/ATLAS using the James Webb Space Telescope.

Its hydrogen isotopes offered evidence about temperature and radiation in the environment in which 3I/ATLAS formed. Its carbon isotope ratios offered clues about the composition of the interstellar gas cloud that gave rise to 3I/ATLAS and



The Hubble telescope's image of the interstellar comet 3I/ATLAS on July 21, 2025, when the comet was 446 million km from the earth. NASA

its home planetary system.

The carbon composition indicated 3I/ATLAS formed some 12 billion years ago during a period of intense star formation in its region. The universe is thought to have begun with the Big Bang event 13.8 billion years ago, so 3I/ATLAS would date to a time when the cosmos was only around 13% of its current age.

For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject 'Daily page'

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Persons arrested by Turkey weeks ahead of NATO summit

209 Two weeks before hosting a NATO summit that will be attended by leaders including U.S. President Donald Trump, Turkey arrested over 200 people with alleged ties to jihadist and far-left groups. Rights groups and local media said the detainees included a journalist, three lawyers, an academic and a union official. AFP

Number of districts most vulnerable to crop damage

111 The government has identified 111 districts as most vulnerable to crop damage as a 43% monsoon deficit driven by El Nino threatens Kharif sowing, Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said on Tuesday. Mr. Chouhan said weak monsoon conditions were likely to persist until July 2, leaving little time for farmers to plant the Kharif (summer) crop. PTI

Number of rape cases recorded in Maharashtra in 2025

8,643 Maharashtra registered 47,954 cases of crimes against women in 2024, the second highest in the country, Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said on Tuesday. He stated that 8,643 rape cases were recorded in 2025, an increase of 703 from the previous year, while the number of crimes against children rose by 482. PTI

India-bound ships transited through Strait of Hormuz

11 Eleven India-bound ships have transited through the Strait of Hormuz after the U.S. and Iran finalised a Memorandum of Understanding to end the West Asia conflict. External Affairs Ministry spokesman Randhir Jaiswal said on Tuesday. The vessels include three Indian-flagged crude oil tankers, each carrying over 2,85,000 metric tonne crude oil, he said. PTI

Number of old flyovers to be repaired by Delhi govt. across city

44 The Delhi government plans to conduct structural audit of 44 old flyovers across the city in a move aimed at improving commuter safety, PWD Minister Parvesh Verma said on Tuesday. The Public Works Department has decided to hire a consultant to carry out the survey of the flyovers older than 15 years and submit a report. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us facebook.com/thehindu [X.com/the_hindu](https://x.com/the_hindu) instagram.com/the_hindu

Is RSS a legal person?

Should the RSS be formally registered under law? Has it been recognised in law or court cases? Can an unregistered body sue or be sued? Are RSS-affiliated organisations legally registered? What regulatory gap does the RSS debate highlight?

EXPLAINER

Rizmi Lia M.

The story so far:

Karnataka Home Minister Priyank Kharge, in a letter dated June 13 addressing the Sarsanghchalak (chief) of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), Mohan Bhagwat, questioned the legal status of the RSS.

In an accompanying post on social media platform X, Mr. Kharge asked, “If citizens, labour, NGOs, trusts, temples and companies are expected to register, disclose and comply with the law, why should the RSS remain exempt?”

He raised similar questions towards the end of last year as well regarding the legal existence of RSS. He has asked about the registration, organisation structure, funding and donation and also about the overall functioning of the organisation.

What is a legal person?

According to legal theorist John Salmond, “A person is any being whom the law regards as capable of rights and bound by legal duties.” The term ‘person’ is further classified into two terms: ‘natural person’ and ‘juridical/artificial person’. Generally, in law, a living human being is considered a natural person. However, a juridical/artificial person is an entity created by law that possesses legal rights and obligations distinct from its members or the individuals associated with it. For example, companies incorporated under the Companies Act are artificial persons, statutorily recognised as legal persons.

To be a company, certain criteria must be met according to Section 9 of the Companies Act, 2013. That includes that, after registration, a company shall be a body corporate by the name contained in its memorandum - “capable of exercising all the functions of an incorporated company under this Act, having perpetual succession, having a common seal with power to acquire, hold and dispose of property both movable and immovable, tangible and intangible, to contract and to sue and be sued” by the said name.

How does RSS describe itself and what is its organisational nature?

In a similar exchange in December 2025, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat described the organisation as “a body of individuals”. RSS in itself is a socio-cultural voluntary organisation with an ideal “to carry the nation to the pinnacle of glory through organising the entire society and ensuring protection of Hindu Dharma”, according to the website.

RSS has been addressed as an “association of persons”, according to the *Commissioner Of Income Tax v Rastriya Swayam Sangh* on February 22, 1994, in which they have been sued with respect to tax exemption.

The Income-tax Appellate Tribunal has referred this matter to Patna High Court to address whether the amount received from members and devotees can be taken to be *Gurudakshina* (token of gratitude to teacher) and thus be exempt from taxation. The court held that the amount received from members can be taken to be *Gurudakshina* and be exempted from tax.

Section 2(31) of the Income Tax Act, 1961, defines ‘person’ expansively and includes a ‘body of individuals’, whether incorporated or not. Under the 1961 Act, the ‘body of individuals’ is a separate taxable entity comprising exclusively



Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh workers perform at a training camp closing ceremony, in Sambalpur on Saturday. RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat describes the organisation as “a body of individuals”. ANI

natural persons (human beings) who have come together for a shared purpose.

Generally, unregistered bodies cannot sue or be sued in their own names, as they are not considered separate legal persons.

The organisation is, however, named as a distinct party in cases including *Singhai Lal Chand Jain v Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh* on February 15, 1996 in the Supreme Court of India. The case revolved around the eviction of the RSS from certain premises in Panna, Madhya Pradesh, initiated by the appellant, Singhai Lal Chand Jain. The appellant filed a civil suit seeking the eviction of the RSS and its office-bearers, alleging unauthorised occupation of the premises. Holding that the RSS was properly represented by its Manager, President, and a member who jointly defended the suit, the court upheld the eviction decree.

What are the legal options for registering a voluntary association in India?

Registering a voluntary association in India requires choosing one of three primary legal structures: a Society (under the Societies Registration Act, 1860), a Trust (under the Indian Trusts Act, 1882), or a Section 8 Company (under the Companies Act, 2013).

The company after incorporation intends to apply its profits, if any, or other income only for promoting its cited objects.

What about donations/Gurudakshina?

As mentioned earlier, the RSS's legal status came under scrutiny in the 1970s during tax proceedings in Bombay and Patna. The disputes centred on whether donations received as “*gurudakshina*” from RSS workers were taxable. In the case of *Commissioner Of Income-Tax v Rastriya Swayam Sevak Sangh* on 22 February, 1994, The Patna High Court addressed the matter and exempted RSS from taxes, considering donations from members as *Gurudakshina*. Also, the

Income Tax Act considers a ‘body of individuals’ as a ‘person’, as mentioned above.

There is the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA), 2010, which regulates the acceptance and utilisation of foreign contribution or foreign hospitality by certain individuals or associations or companies. Any donation, delivery or transfer received from a ‘foreign source’ whether in rupees or in foreign currency, is construed as a ‘foreign contribution’ under FCRA, 2010.

Even for the grant of registration under FCRA, the association should be registered under an existing statute like the Societies Registration Act, 1860 or the Indian Trusts Act, 1882 or Section 8 of Companies Act, 2013 etc. The association should be in existence for at least three years and has undertaken reasonable activity in its chosen field for the benefit of the society for which the foreign contribution is proposed to be utilised. And the applicant NGO/association will be free to choose its items of expenditure (excluding the administrative expenditure as defined in Rule 5 of FCRR, 2011) to become eligible for the minimum threshold of ₹15 lakh spent during the last three years.

How can one join RSS?

According to the Frequently Asked Questions section of the RSS website powered by Bharati Web Private Limited, “there is no formal membership enrolment in the RSS. Anyone can approach the nearest ‘Shakha’, which is the fundamental unit of activity of RSS and become a swayamsevak. There are no fees, no registration form, and no formal application. Once you start attending the daily shakha either in the morning or in the evening as per your convenience, you become the swayamsevak of RSS. It is that simple. If someone does not know any shakha or Swayamsevak nearby, One can join the RSS online too.”

Any person who wants to work towards the *sanatan dharma* can join the RSS, even if they don’t visit the shakhas.

There is no formal procedure or criterion that stops anybody for that matter from joining the organisation. There is a registration form on the website that requires one to fill up primary details for the same.

What are the RSS affiliates and are they registered?

There are around 32 sister organisations that work under the umbrella of RSS, with many more like-minded organisations. The Akhil Bhartiya Vidhyarthi Parishad, the Vidya Bharti, Bharatiya Janata Party, Vishva Hindu Parishad, Bajrang Dal, Durga Vahini, Dharam Sansad or Religious Parliament etc.

The list of RSS-affiliated bodies is vast and spans every sector of Indian society: students, education, labour, agriculture, women, tribals, culture, science, law, economics, publishing, and more. However, each of these is registered under different laws.

For example, the student body Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad began its activities around 1948 and was registered on July 9, 1949, as a non-governmental organisation (NGO) under the Societies Registration Act of 1860. Thus, the units of the RSS function as registered entities.

Trade union Bharatiya Mazdoor Sangh functions within the legal framework governing labour organisations. Educational, social-service and tribal welfare bodies associated with the Sangh generally operate through registered trusts and societies.

RSS continues to describe itself as a voluntary socio-cultural organisation and a body of individuals rather than a registered corporate entity. Court records show that it has been recognised in tax proceedings and litigation, while many organisations associated with the Sangh function through separately registered bodies.

Mr. Kharge’s questions, however, have renewed the debate over whether an organisation of the RSS’s scale and reach should continue to operate without a formal registration framework.

THE GIST

According to legal theorist John Salmond, “A person is any being whom the law regards as capable of rights and bound by legal duties.”

The RSS’s legal status came under scrutiny in the 1970s during tax proceedings in Bombay and Patna. The disputes centred on whether donations received as “*guru dakshina*” from RSS workers were taxable.

RSS continues to describe itself as a voluntary socio-cultural organisation and a body of individuals rather than a registered corporate entity.

